

the hindu businessline

bl.portfolio

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

Invisible engines.
Decoding the data centre ecosystem – business, economics and opportunities
BIG STORY P2

Index Outlook.
The price action leaves the bias positive; benchmarks likely to see more rise
CHART-GAZING P7

Markets' dilemma: Trust the bark or wag of oil prices

SPLIT SIGNALS. Surge in physical oil prices alongside a steep fall in futures underscores a stark divergence, with the gap between the two widening to historic highs

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The spot oil market is barking loudly. Last week it rallied to an all-time high of \$144.46/barrel — levels not seen even during the frenzied rally of 2007-08 or the spike during the Russia-Ukraine war. Ideally that should scare stock market investors as too high an oil price, even if only over medium-term durations, can eventually lead to demand destruction and slow economic growth.

However, at the same time, the tail in the form of the oil futures market is wagging strong, signalling an optimistic picture. Decoding this tale of contrasts holds the key to the direction of stock markets from hereon.

Last week, the market sentiment improved after the announcement of a ceasefire in the US-Israel and Iran conflict. Benchmark Nifty 50 rallied 6 per cent — its biggest weekly gain since February 2021. In the US, the S&P 500 and Dow Jones rose over 3 per cent each, marking their strongest weekly performance since November last

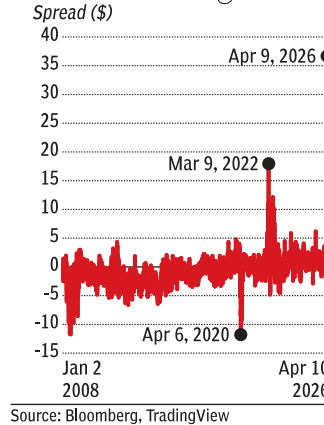
year. This was in direct response to oil futures correcting sharply through the course of last week. The front-month Brent crude futures (\$95.20/barrel) fell nearly 13 per cent last week and is now down about 20 per cent from the March 9 peak of \$119.50. The decline reflects hopes of easing supply disruptions, particularly around the Strait of Hormuz.

For now, the markets seem to be trusting the wag. But are they making the risk of ignoring the ground realities?

OPTIMISM VS OPERATIONAL REALITY
Dated Brent, the primary benchmark for physical crude, surged to a lifetime high of \$144.46/barrel on April 7 before moderating to around \$125.88 (compared with \$137.67 during the onset of the Russia-Ukraine war in March 2022).

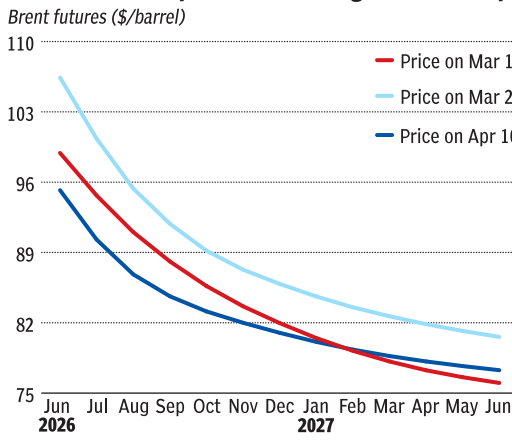
The divergence between Dated Brent and Brent futures has widened significantly since March 20, when futures began to soften. The spread (Dated Brent minus June Brent futures) hit a record high of \$35.87 on April 9, signalling a disconnect

Physical oil premium hits record high



Source: Bloomberg, TradingView

Backwardation persists but long-end firms up



between expectations and current conditions

At the core of this divergence is a classic mismatch — futures price expectations and hope, while Dated Brent reflects immediate supply realities.

The disruption around the Strait of Hormuz has created severe tightness in prompt supply. Buyers are scrambling for immediately deliverable cargoes, “prompt barrels”, keeping Dated Brent elevated.

On the other hand, cease-

fire-related optimism has compressed the geopolitical risk premium in futures. The reality, however, is far more complex, which the Dated Brent seems to be reflecting.

About 20 million barrels per day (bpd), which is nearly 20 per cent of global crude supply, passes through the Strait of Hormuz. Even with alternate routes such as Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline, a shortfall of over 10 million bpd could persist, leaving a significant supply gap.

Adding to this, Middle East

producers shut in about 7.5 million bpd in March due to storage constraints, with outages projected to rise to 9.1 million bpd in April, according to the Energy Information Administration — highlighting the scale of supply disruptions.

With exports disrupted as the inability to move the oil out of the Persian Gulf has resulted in the energy commodity piling up at storage hubs, reaching in what is referred to as “tank top”. This raises the risk of production

shut-ins, further tightening prompt supply.

Crucially, even if Hormuz reopens fully, supply cannot normalise instantly. Damage to infrastructure, elevated insurance costs and logistical bottlenecks could delay stabilisation by 2-4 weeks. Bringing idled oil production facilities back on stream can take anywhere from four weeks or longer depending on how modernised the facility is.

Even where flows resume, execution remains difficult. War-risk insurance premiums have reportedly surged up to 1,000 per cent, while tanker freight rates have spiked.

All these factors ensure that immediate supply remains scarce, keeping Dated Brent at a premium. This also suggests that spot prices could remain higher for longer, than what the futures markets are expecting right now.

The key reason futures are not fully reflecting this stress is timing. Dated Brent reflects cargoes deliverable within 10 days to a month, whereas the front-month Brent futures contract represents June delivery — further out on the fu-

tures curve.

That said, both markets agree on one thing — the structure remains in backwardation, where near-term prices are higher than longer-dated contracts — a classic signal of tight supply. However, small shift in the futures curve (refer chart) suggest markets may be beginning to price in a more prolonged disruption.

Broadly, while futures are pricing a potential easing of disruptions, Dated Brent captures the reality of current constraints.

STOCK VS FLOW

This dynamic can be understood through what Steve Liesman of CNBC terms the “stock versus flow” problem. The “flow” issue refers to residual supplies still arriving from shipments that crossed before disruptions. The “stock” issue emerges if Hormuz remains shut for longer, causing flows to decline and inventories to deplete.

This transition from flow to stock stress will be critical over the next few weeks. And that is when investors may begin to fear the bark more than take comfort in the wagging tail.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Caplin Point: Accumulate

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Caplin Point has remained in a consolidation phase over the past year. Revenue growth has been driven by the US injectables business, while the LatAm segment has been relatively muted.

With valuations correcting from 32x one-year forward earnings in January 2025 to about 19x currently, we recommend accumulating the stock.

The company is expected to deliver industry-level revenue growth of 11-12 per cent year-on-year over the next two years, led by US expansion, while maintaining a strong margin profile.

Beyond FY28, the company is preparing for its next growth phase, driven by expansion in Chile and Mexico in LatAm, oncology portfolio launches, and scaling up its US label portfolio. It remains well-funded to execute capacity expansion, with no debt and cash equivalents of ₹1,300 crore as of December 2025.

SEBI launches 3 platforms for cybersecurity

Asian News International
New Delhi

To enhance ease of doing business and strengthen cybersecurity oversight, the Securities and Exchange Board of India said its Chairman had launched three IT platforms on March 24.

The initiatives — SUPCOMS, the e-adjudication portal, and Cyber-Sec Audit Compliance (C-SAC) — aim to streamline communication, digitise quasi-judicial processes, and bolster cybersecurity supervision of SEBI-regulated entities.

SUPCOMS is a unified communication platform that replaces traditional email-based interactions with SEBI. It ensures all correspondence is centrally accessible, while creating a robust institutional memory.

AUDIT TRAIL

“The implementation of SUPCOMS leads to the creation of a robust Institutional Memory. By centralising all official interactions with external entities, the platform ensures an audit trail of communications and prevents fragmented communication and broken reply chains,” it added.

SEBI said its e-adjudication portal is a next-generation platform that digitally enables quasi-judicial proceedings, offering a transparent interface for all stakeholders.

It allows entities to access and download show-cause notices, submit replies, and participate in hearings through an online module.

C-SAC, an AI-enabled platform, strengthens cybersecurity supervision by analysing cyber audit reports, identifying compliance gaps and risk areas, and generating actionable insights.

The platform improves efficiency, reduces manual effort, and supports timely, data-driven supervisory decisions.

India Inc flags surge in packaging raw material costs, asks govt for relief measures

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

India Inc has flagged concerns over a sharp rise in packaging and related raw material costs triggered by the West Asia conflict. Volatility in crude oil prices, elevated logistics costs and rupee depreciation are disrupting packaging supply chains across sectors.

At the same time, rationalisation of commercial LPG has also impacted glass bottle production, widely used in the beverages industry.

Sources said that in recent meetings with government officials, industry bodies sought measures to mitigate the impact, particularly on smaller players.

Key suggestions include faster release of input tax credit — which locks up working capital, especially for MSMEs — and removal

of anti-dumping duties on select materials to enable diversified imports.

MARGINS HIT

“With costs of some raw materials up by almost 50 per cent, margins of businesses are getting severely impacted. In fact, MSMEs are facing difficulties in managing working capital. For instance, PET resin landed cost has surged to ₹133.50 as of April 8 from ₹90,” a senior executive with a leading consumer goods company said.

PRICEY DERIVATIVES

Industry executives said polymer prices have risen 50-60 per cent, while inks, varnishes and adhesives are up about 30 per cent. Prices of sulphur, naphtha and glycols are up 30-40 per cent. With limited domestic manufacturing capacity for several crude derivatives, concerns over potential



shortages are also emerging.

While the ceasefire offers some respite, players cautioned that supply chains do not normalise overnight.

Suraj Mehta, Chief Strategy Officer, Hindustan National Glass and Industries Ltd, said, “We are currently operating with nearly up to 50 per cent cuts in commercial LPG supplies across our six plants. While we have increased reliance on alternatives like LNG, capacity utilisation across our plants is in the range of 40-60 per cent. This is beginning to impact high-demand sec-

tors like beer and soft beverages, especially with the summer season approaching, where demand is strong but supply remains constrained, leading to emerging shortages of container glass bottles.”

Mayank Shah, Vice-President, Parle Products, said that packaging costs for the FMCG industry has increased 15-20 per cent.

MSMEs TAKE THE HIT

Thimmaiah NP, MD & CEO, Alternicq, noted, “The packaging industry is experiencing tighter supply conditions, with longer lead times and more allocation-driven supply. The impact is more pronounced for smaller players with limited access to working capital and supplier relationships. For end markets, if the current conditions persist, part of these cost pressures may gradually flow through into product pricing.”

PEACE PITCH



TRILATERAL TALKS. A combo picture of the Pakistani Prime Minister Shahbaz Sharif (right) with US Vice-President JD Vance (above) and Iranian Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf as the two warring nations head for peace talks in Islamabad on Saturday. However, the question of the ceasefire being extended to Lebanon, which is opposed by Israel, may play the spoilsport. REUTERS

Centre hikes windfall gains tax on diesel, ATF for exports

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With global crude prices still elevated, the Finance Ministry on Saturday hiked the windfall gain tax on export bound diesel and aviation turbine fuel (ATF) by 158 per cent 42 per cent, respectively, with immediate effect.

This is the first revision after the levy was reimposed on March 26.

According to a set of notifications, the windfall levy on diesel will be ₹55.5 a litre up from ₹21.5. Export-bound jet fuel will attract a levy of ₹42 a litre as against ₹29.5.

Export duty on petrol continues to remain Nil. Government officials

made it clear that the revision is not about boosting revenue for the government, “it is more about not allowing exporters to take undue advantage due to price differences.”

On March 26, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had said that the levy on diesel and ATF for export had been raised to ensure that the fuel is prioritised for domestic use.

These changes come at a time when crude prices after going over \$120 a barrel have slipped to \$95-96. However, product prices still remain high.

With Indian refineries operating at high capacity and exporting petroleum products, the government has reworked the levy.

Draft Delhi EV Policy for full shift to 3Ws by 2027, 2Ws by 2028

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The Delhi government on Saturday released a draft electric vehicle (EV) policy proposing that new registrations will be restricted to electric three-wheelers starting January 2027 and electric two-wheelers from April 2028, marking a shift from incentives-led adoption to a deadline-driven transition.

The Draft Delhi EV Policy 2026-30 sets clear electrification targets for key vehicle segments, supported by a combination of subsidies, scrappage incentives and tax exemptions aimed at accelerating early adoption.

Details p12

UPI @ 10: From payments pipe to backbone of India's digital financial ecosystem

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

A decade after its launch, India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has evolved from a simple money transfer system into the backbone of the country's digital economy, clocking exponential growth in both scale and scope.

219 B TRANSACTIONS

From just 17.86 million transactions worth ₹6,952 crore in FY17, UPI has surged to 218.98 billion transactions totalling nearly ₹285 lakh crore in FY26, according to Tracxn data.

Monthly transaction value has risen from ₹21 lakh crore in FY20 to about ₹30 lakh



crore, underscoring strong post-pandemic adoption.

The platform now serves around 400 million active users, with nearly 250 million daily users and about 450 million monthly users, as highlighted by CRED co-founder Kunal Shah. UPI is also gaining traction in recurring payments, with close to 100 million autopay mandates and around 500 million monthly autopay debits. Industry executives attribute UPI's suc-

cess to its ability to democratise digital payments. “UPI has successfully decoupled digital payments from high-end hardware and high-income brackets to driving genuine financial inclusion across the country,” said Rahul Chari, Co-Founder and CTO of PhonePe and Chairman of the UPI Committee at the Payments Council of India.

Even as subsidies taper, UPI continues to grow at around 30 per cent, with the next milestone being one billion users over the coming decade. Chari noted that UPI is increasingly becoming a financial identity across demographics. “If the first decade was about access and adoption, the next will be defined by depth — of usage,

engagement and real financial empowerment,” said Prakash Sikaria, CEO and Founder of super.money.

FULL STACK ECOSYSTEM

UPI is now evolving into a full-stack financial ecosystem, enabling first-time users to access formal credit and build financial confidence. The emergence of credit lines on UPI is expected to unlock significant opportunities, particularly for underserved segments.

As competition intensifies and innovation deepens, UPI's next chapter is likely to be shaped by personalised financial services, AI-driven experiences and broader inclusion.

b1.portfolio

Evolution of data centres over the years

1940s-1950s
Data centres date back to the 1940s, when large mainframe computers needed dedicated space because of their size, power draw and cooling needs. One early example was the U.S. Army's Electronic Numerical Integrator and Computer, completed in 1945 at the University of Pennsylvania

1960s-1970s
In the 1960s and 1970s, businesses increasingly adopted mainframes, prompting dedicated computer facilities. IBM expanded this trend in the 1970s by building standardized sites for its mainframe systems, helping meet rising demand for large-scale data processing

1980s
The 1980s brought a shift to client-server architecture, creating demand for dedicated spaces for servers and networking gear. This laid the foundation for modern data centres, as organizations increasingly centralized IT resources to handle growing computing needs

1990s
The rise of the internet in the 1990s led to a surge in demand for data centres. Companies required robust infrastructure to host websites and manage online services, resulting in the rapid expansion of data centre facilities

2000s
In the 2000s, advances in virtualization improved server efficiency and paved the way for cloud computing. Data centres evolved to support scalable, flexible IT services, fundamentally changing how businesses deployed infrastructure and managed an increasingly digital set of operations

2010s
The 2010s introduced hyperscale data centres, massive facilities designed to support extensive data processing and storage needs of tech giants. Concurrently, edge computing emerged, bringing data processing closer to end-users to reduce latency and improve performance

2020s
In the current decade, data centres are adapting to support artificial intelligence workloads, which require significant computing power. There's also a heightened emphasis on sustainability, with initiatives aimed at reducing energy consumption and environmental impact

Source: FS, IBM, Prosource, SFGATE, JM Financial

Into the world of data centres

INVISIBLE ENGINES. AI, cloud demand and costs are reshaping infrastructure, economics, risks and investment opportunities across India and global markets for this crucial digital backbone

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Every digital activity leaves a physical trail. When you make a UPI payment, stream Netflix, back up WhatsApp, place a stock market trade or ask ChatGPT a question, that request travels to a data centre, where servers process it and send a response back in milliseconds. Once seen as the Internet's invisible plumbing, data centres are now at the centre of a global infra boom driven by AI, cloud computing & surging digital traffic.

The data centre industry uses an unusual convention: Although operators are effectively digital landlords renting out space and computing capacity, facilities are sized and marketed by the electrical power available to IT equipment, expressed in MW or GW of "IT load", rather than by floor area, or data handled. Realty consultant Knight Frank estimates data centre global live IT capacity at about 60 GW in 2025, rising to over 93 GW in 2027, while another consultant JLL sees as much as 100 GW of new capacity by 2030.

The global rush has been extraordinary, and data centres are changing with it. AI facilities need far more power, cooling and electrical infra than older ones, as large language models can require 10-100 times the computing power of traditional applications. By 2030, AI could account for half of all computing activity, with running trained AI models driving most of it.

That template is now playing out in India too. Despite generating an estimated 20 per cent of the world's digital data, our data centre market remains far smaller than those of the US or China, though it is among the fastest-growing, with capacity rising from about 0.375 GW in 2020 to around 1.5 GW by 2025 (estimated 130-150 active data centres). Mumbai and Chennai account for a lion's share of installed co-location capacity today because of their proximity to sub-sea cable landing stations. Projections suggest a three-seven-fold rise in national capacity by 2030, to 4.5-10 GW. Hyperscalers (typically large cloud providers), such as AWS, Microsoft, Google and Oracle, already account for more than half of India's data centre IT capacity, with BFSI and IT & Telecom being the other major clients.

Below, we unpack data centre business, economics and opportunities.

NOT JUST SERVERS

A visit to a modern data centre feels more like entering a military facility: Armed guards, multiple biometric checks and man-trap doors outside, followed by long corridors of blinking server racks, thick cables and icy air inside.

A modern data centre is 5 things rolled into one. A secure building housing servers and storage, a private electricity system with multiple layers of backup, a cooling system designed to remove huge amounts of heat, a network hub connected to fibre-optic cables and the wider Internet, and computing power from central processing units (CPUs), graphics processing units (GPUs), & specialised chips.

According to BofA Global Research, IT equipment (servers, networking, storage) accounts for 79 per cent of the cost, followed by engineering, contractor, building and installation costs (E&C) at 11 per cent, electrical equipment at 5 per cent,

thermal or cooling equipment at 4 per cent & backup diesel generators at 1-2 per cent.

Traditional data centres are built on-site and expanded gradually, making them slower to deploy but more customisable. Modular facilities, by contrast, use prefabricated units that cut construction time from 18-24 months to 6-12 months.

But the faster data centres scale, the harder it becomes to ignore their side-effects. Beyond land and capital, these facilities place heavy demands on power grids, water resources and local infrastructure.

DIFFERENT MODELS

Data centres can broadly be understood through four models.

Captive or enterprise data centres are owned and run by a company for its own workloads. These give tighter control over security, compliance and design, but trade-off is high capex, lower flexibility and the burden of managing power, cooling and security in-house.

Co-location (colo) data centres are shared facilities where multiple customers rent space, power and connectivity from an operator such as Equinix or Digital Realty. They reduce upfront costs and improve scalability but offer less control than captive set-ups and leave users dependent on operator uptime and pricing. In India, the average colo capex per MW in India is ₹46.5 crore/\$5.4 million and this works out to roughly ₹24,200 of capex per sq ft, per JM Financial. Research by Soben (part of Accenture) found that cloud data centres currently cost between \$8 million and \$10 million per MW, 1 GW-plus AI data centres are costing as much as \$17 million per MW. This gap reflects differences in scope, geography, design assumptions, and included IT and hardware.

Hyperscale data centres refer more to size and intensity than ownership. These are giant campuses built for Amazon, Microsoft, Google and Meta etc., either for their own use or through leased capacity from operators. They deliver scale and efficiency, but require huge power, land and capital. A newer variation of this buildout is CoreWeave, which is closer to an AI-focused leased-infrastructure model built around GPU cloud workloads.

Edge data centres are smaller, decentralised facilities placed closer to users and devices, often below 10 MW in India. Telecom operators use such set-ups to cut latency & support real-time applications, though these usually offer lower redundancy & uptime than large centralised facilities.

BUSINESS ECONOMICS

Data centres generate revenue through pricing models based on rack units (server slots), full racks (entire cabinets), cages (private enclosed areas) and other formats, with pricing increasingly linked to the amount of power allocated to them. Rates depend on location, power availability, network density, uptime, security and contract structure. Pricing can also vary by customer size. Retail and wholesale colo contracts typically run for three-five years, while hyperscaler deals usually last at least five years and can extend to 10.

Broadly, there are two revenue models. In the dominant lease model, the data centre operator rents out space, power and cooling, while the customer manages its own IT infrastructure. In managed services, the operator also provides cloud or IT infrastructure and charges on a usage

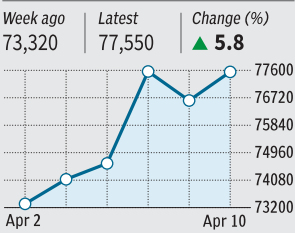
WISE WORDS.

Great investing requires both generating returns and controlling risk. And recognizing risk is an absolute prerequisite for controlling it.

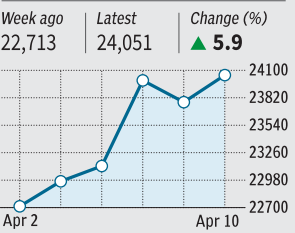
HOWARD MARKS
Co-founder of Oaktree Capital Management

MARKET ACTION.

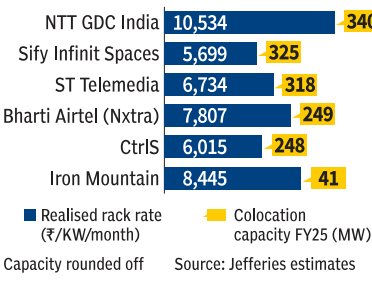
SENSEX



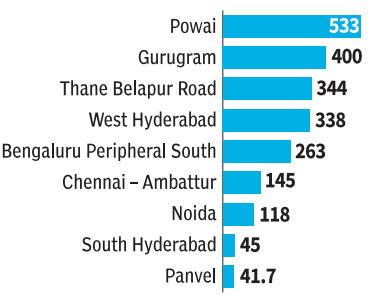
NIFTY



Realised rack rates across different colocation operators

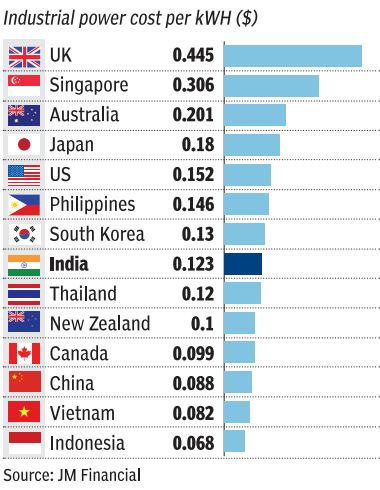


Land and site acquisition cost for a 5-acre land parcel with 50MW build capacity



Source: C&W Research | Asia Pacific - Data centres Construction Cost Guide 2025

India's power cost is competitive globally



Source: JM Financial

basis. In India, lease rentals can be around ₹10-11 crore per MW per year, with utilities typically passed through separately.

Besides pricing and capacity, a data centre's profitability depends on occupancy and cost control.

In India, colo occupancy has climbed sharply, from 82 per cent in FY20 to 97 per cent in FY25. With facilities now running at 95-97 per cent occupancy, fresh additions are becoming increasingly critical.

On pricing, the most useful current benchmark is realised rack rate, which Jefferies estimates at an aggregate ₹7,428 per kW per month in FY25. Monthly pricing, typically, falls as customer size rises.

Power is the single-most vital resource for data centre operations. Thanks to renewable power, India is not short of electricity in aggregate. But that does not automatically mean every location has easy, reliable and scalable access. Tariff classification matters, since data centres usually seek industrial power rates.

Change in energy costs can hit or benefit reported EBITDA margins (FY25: of 37-44 per cent for players in India and 47-51 per cent for global firms). Power density has increased thanks to GPUs, which are now central to modern computing, especially in AI, data analytics, and high-performance computing. For context, NVIDIA H100 and H200 GPU-based racks typically draw about 10-30 kW each, marking a sharp jump from legacy enterprise densities. While traditional racks used about 12 kW, AI-ready racks can require 80-120 kW for training. For understanding, a single 100 kW AI rack running 24/7 in India (at ₹8-10 per unit/kWh) would cost ₹6-7 lakh per month just in electricity, before cooling or floor space costs.

Long-term renewable power purchase agreements (PPAs), too, help lock in lower energy costs. Some States offering electricity-duty waivers or concessional tariffs make certain locations more attractive.

Data centres are also highly capital-in-

tensive businesses. McKinsey research shows that by 2030, data centres are projected to require \$6.7 trillion worldwide to keep pace with the demand for compute power. This makes financing costs crucial.

Debt is a standard part of funding expansion. Interest costs can materially affect margins, especially when operators add capacity aggressively before utilisation ramps up. Reported net debt/EBITDA ratios for major operators range from under two times for some players to above five-seven times for more leveraged ones, with global Real Estate Investment Trust (REIT)-like players often in the 3.8-4.4 times range. In the asset-intensive data centre industry, depreciation can be a key swing factor. High depreciation in the early years of capacity expansion tends to depress EBIT, ROCE and PAT.

Given the growth potential, the sector is attracting institutional capital. According to industry estimates, India's data centre market has attracted nearly \$94 billion in investments since 2019. For instance, Airtel on March 30 announced a \$1-billion investment in its subsidiary Nxtra, which operates 14 large core data centres and 120+ edge facilities, by Alpha Wave, Carlyle and Anchorage Capital, with Airtel also participating. In November 2025, Tata Group's TCS partnered with PE giant TPG to scale HyperVault, targeting over 1 GW of AI-ready data-centre capacity with investments of up to ₹18,000 crore (about \$2 billion). And just days ago, it was announced that TCS HyperVault and AMD will co-develop a rack-scale AI design and a 200 MW AI-ready data centre blueprint, while working with hyperscalers and AI firms in India.

Bigger conglomerates have also unveiled ambitious plans this year. Adani Group plans to invest \$100 billion by 2035 in renewable-powered, AI-ready data centres, backed by a parallel scale-up in renewable energy & storage. RIL has outlined a \$110-billion, seven-year AI infra plan spanning gigawatt-scale data centres, a nationwide edge-computing network & AI services integrated with Jio.

DATA CENTRE VALUE CHAIN

A data centre draws on a wide vendor ecosystem. The server layer includes the likes of Dell and Hewlett Packard, while networking gear comes from Cisco, Arista Networks and Juniper Networks. The electrical backbone spans UPS systems, switchgear, power distribution units (PDU's), with vendors such as Schneider Electric, Vertiv, Eaton and ABB. The cooling stack includes chillers from firms such as Johnson Controls, Trane, Carrier and Daikin; heat-rejection equipment such as cooling towers, dry coolers and related systems from SPX Technologies, Ebara and Kelvion; and computer room air handlers (CRAHs) from Vertiv, STULZ and Johnson Controls. Back-up power comes from suppliers such as Caterpillar, Rolls-Royce mtu and Cummins. Large projects also rely on engineering and design firms such as Jacobs, Burns & McDonnell and WSP, along with construction specialists such as Turner, Holder and HITT.

In India, the value chain spans multiple listed and unlisted players. E2E Networks, as a specialised AI-cloud provider, competes with AWS, Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud. Cooling needs create opportunities for Voltas, Blue Star and Hitachi. The telecom opportunity is served by Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel, Tata Communications etc. The electrical and power layer is served by firms such as Hitachi En-

ergy India, ABB India, Siemens Energy, Schneider Electric and CG Power, while cables/switchgear names such as Polycab, KEL, Havells are also often cited. Land, shell and real-estate development involve players such as Brookfield, Blackstone, Embassy and Lodha. Some, such as Anant Raj, are using their existing land banks through Anant Raj Cloud to build AI-ready data centres. Racks, fit-outs and project execution draw in Larsen & Toubro, Sterling and Wilson, NCC etc.

Budget 2026 proposed a 20-year tax holiday, till 2047, for eligible foreign cloud companies using Indian DCs for global operations. This adds to a broader regulatory tailwind from the RBI's 2018 payments-data localisation mandate, MeitY's Data Centre Policy 2020, SEBI's 2023 data-in-India rule for regulated entities, the DPDP Act 2023 and the IndiaAI Mission 2024.

Yet India's expansion is not frictionless. A new data centre requires close to 30 approvals or permissions from Central and State government departments before it can start operations. Even if India does not face an overall national power shortage, the availability of reliable electricity varies sharply across cities and sites. The biggest challenge may, therefore, be execution.

None of the pure-play data centres are listed in India till now. Sify's data centre business (Sify Infinitt Spaces) may be the first to list. Investors should understand that in the builder-operator model, cash flows are back-ended. Operators spend heavily on land, power infra and construction long before utilisation matures, so near-term free cash flow can look weak even if the underlying asset is attractive. Large builds can be EBITDA-negative or cash-flow negative until utilisation ramps, which is one reason private capital often dominates the sector.

HOW TO ASSESS THE THEME

Long-duration demand, sticky customers, high switching costs and rising value for power-rich, well-connected campuses are positives. The cons include huge upfront capital needs, long gestation, execution risk on power and approvals, & uncertain returns if excess capacity is built at once. A data centre REIT may generate steady rental income, but because it distributes most of its cash flows, future growth often has to be funded through fresh debt, equity issuance or asset sales.

Some investors, especially in India, may see the opportunity as a "during a gold rush, sell shovels" story. Investors still need to judge how seriously each company is targeting the opportunity, what the management says on con-calls, whether order-wins are translating into revenue and whether margins are attractive enough to matter.

For investors, the checklist should vary by segment. In power and electrical equipment, assess product relevance, execution capability, order inflow, margin profile & competitive intensity. In cooling, check whether there is genuine data-centre-grade capability or is merely using the theme as a narrative. In construction and fit-outs, study project scale, EPC execution, working-capital demands & margin sustainability. In telecom & fibre, understand whether data centre demand can materially lift utilisation & returns. Across all names, investors need to judge whether the exposure is real and scalable, whether it can materially improve profits, & whether valuations already price in too much optimism.

How listed data centre stock valuations stack up

Company	Local currency	M-cap (billion)	1-yr stock return %	Price to book	EV/ EBITDA	EV/sales
Digital Realty Trust (REIT)*	US dollar	65.81	28.9	2.9	88.6	13.5
Equinix	US dollar	101.4	29.4	7.2	29.3	13.1
Iron Mountain	US dollar	32.3	28.6	NA	19	7.5
NEXTDC	AU dollar	8.2	27.7	2	47	23
CoreWeave	US dollar	49.4	88.5	13.9	23.5	14.8
GDS Holdings	HK dollar	68	118.8	2.2	27.4	8.2
Keppel DC (REIT)*	SG dollar	5.6	21.1	1.4	23.3	17.5

is on April 9, 2026 Rounded off All valuation metrics based on trailing 12-month period *In case of the REITs, adjusted ales has been taken for calculating EV/Sales and adjusted operating income has been taken for computing EV/EBITDA source: Bloomberg



Balaji Vaidyanath
Abinash Swamenathan

Every week, brokerages and research desks put out sector calls. “Bullish on Chemicals.” “Overweight Healthcare.” “Avoid IT.” These come wrapped in macro arguments, demand forecasts and policy tailwinds. They sound authoritative. They read well in morning notes. And for the most part, they are analytically useless.

That’s a strong claim. But we have the data to back it up.

DRONACHARYA’S LESSON
AND THE INVESTOR’S EYE

There is an old story from the Mahabharata that investors would do well to remember. Dronacharya, the great teacher of the Pandavas and Kauravas, once set up a wooden bird on a distant tree and asked his students to aim at its eye. Before releasing their arrows, he asked each one what they could see.

Yudhishthira said he saw the tree, the branches, the bird. Duryodhana said much the same. One by one, the princes described the whole scene. Then Arjuna stepped forward. “I see only the eye of the bird,” he said. He was the only one allowed to shoot, and he struck the target perfectly.

The lesson has survived thousands of years for good reason. Seeing the whole tree is not the same as seeing the target. In investing, a sector call is the equivalent of describing the tree, the branch, the sky and the wind. It is a panoramic view when what you

actually need is a focused one. Arjuna did not waste his attention on the scenery. He locked onto the one thing that mattered. The best investors do the same. They do not ask “which sector?” They ask “which company?”

The rest of this note explains, with hard numbers, why that distinction makes all the difference.

PROBLEM WITH SECTORS

A sector call compresses an entire distribution of stock returns into a single directional view. Buy or sell. Overweight or underweight. It assumes that knowing the sector tells you something meaningful about the individual stocks within it.

We looked at 42 sectors and hundreds of listed Indian companies, measured their one-year returns, and asked a straightforward question: How wide is the gap between the best-performing quartile and the worst-performing quartile within the same sector? This gap, known as the Interquartile Range (IQR), is the clearest measure of how much a sector label actually explains.

The median IQR across all 42 sectors is 33 percentage points. In the typical Indian sector, the top quartile stock outperformed the bottom quartile by 33pp within the same sector, in the same year.

Think about that for a moment. A sector call collapses that entire 33 percentage point spread into a single arrow. Up or down. It tells you which direction the wind is blowing, but nothing about where you actually land within the distribution.

It makes one wonder if it’s actually analysis or a coin toss

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The best investors do not ask ‘which sector’; they ask ‘which company’
- A sector call tells you which direction the wind is blowing, but nothing about where you actually land
- Analyst coverage does not compress sector dispersion; it just means more people are confidently wrong about the same call

dressed up in a research wrapper.

THE DATA

Here is the return dispersion across 10 major sectors. Pay close attention to the IQR column. It captures the distance between the 75th percentile and 25th percentile return within each sector.

Banks: The homogeneous sector argument falls apart

The usual defence of sector calls goes something like this: They make sense for homogeneous sectors. Banks all face the same regulator. They operate under the same interest rate cycle and the same credit environment. If any sector should move in lockstep, it ought to be Banks.

The numbers tell a different story. The IQR for Banks in this period was 54 percentage points. The top quartile returned +35 per cent. The bottom quartile returned –19 per cent. That is a 54-percentage point gap inside a

sector where every company does fundamentally the same business, under the same regulatory framework, lending to overlapping customer segments.

If sector calls fail in the most-structurally homogeneous sector in Indian listed markets, the argument for them everywhere else simply disappears.

Chemicals: The heterogeneous sector problem

Now consider Chemicals. This label covers 117 stocks spanning specialty chemicals, basic chemicals, agrochemicals and intermediates. The total spread between the best and worst performer is a staggering 500 percentage points. One stock returned +443 per cent. Another returned –57 per cent. The median return was –19 per cent, which means more than half the sector actually lost money.

A “bullish Chemicals” call during this period was factually wrong for the majority of stocks in the sector. Is that a call gone wrong or a category error by itself?

Also, what really is ‘Chemical’ sector? Is the label even analytically useful? Seems like it is a filing cabinet label that groups together companies with entirely different raw material profiles, end markets, margin structures and competitive dynamics. Specialty chemicals and commodity chlor alkali have about as much in common as a hospital and a gym. Both happen to fall under “healthcare.”

52-WEEK HIGH/LOW TEST

Return dispersion tells you about the past year. The 52-week high/

low distribution tells you about right now. For each sector, we flagged stocks within 10 per cent of their 52-week high and stocks within 10 per cent of their 52-week low, at the same point in time.

If stocks within a sector genuinely move together, you would not expect many to be sitting near their highs and lows simultaneously. What we found was the opposite:

Healthcare is the starkest example. Out of 127 stocks, 14 per cent were near their 52-week highs, while 46 per cent were near their 52-week lows, at the exact same time. Within the same sector, some companies were having their best year, while others were having their worst. A single directional call on Healthcare is simultaneously right and wrong, depending entirely on which stock you happened to pick.

COVERAGE PARADOX: MORE ANALYSTS, SAME DISPERSION

A reasonable objection at this point would be that sector calls are designed for the large-cap universe — the top 500 companies that brokerages actively cover with dedicated analysts and full financial models. Restrict the study to that universe, the argument goes, and the dispersion should compress.

The data does not support this.

Across the top 500 listed companies in India, the median IQR remains 24 percentage points. In Banks, 25 of the largest and most-covered lenders in the country

index could now be gearing up for a fresh rally in the coming months. This leg of rally may have the potential to take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index up to 22,000, 23,000 over the next one-and-a-half years or so.

Similar pattern is also visible in Nifty 50, Nifty Midcap 150 and Sensex as well. However, the Nifty Smallcap 250 index looks more convincing because of another reason. The index has a strong trendline support at 14,000 and a good bounce is happening from there over the last few weeks.

WHAT TO DO?

While technical analysis can help to give an early entry or exit from the market, as in any forecasting technique, it is not fool-proof. It has its blind sides and hence stop-losses are a very crucial element. Not having stop-losses is like getting onto a car which has no brakes.

Keeping this in mind: Investors who can take a little high risk can hunt for good small-cap stocks to invest now. Those who prefer some passive investments, can consider the following mutual funds.

Nippon India Nifty Smallcap 250 Index Fund, SBI Nifty Smallcap 250 Index Fund, Motilal Oswal Nifty Smallcap 250 Index Fund and ICICI Prudential Nifty Smallcap 250 Index Fund.

STRATEGY

The investment idea given above is purely based on charts. So, individual investors who prefer to buy small-cap stocks have to do their own due diligence. Proper stop-loss should be kept in place to minimise the loss.

Those buying mutual funds, have to look for exits in the 22,000-23,000 region. You may also have to be ready to accept the loss and come out if the Nifty Smallcap 250 index declines below 13,000.

A fall below 13,000 will prove the bullish view wrong. It will also indicate that the history is not repeating.

table 1

Return dispersion within sectors (1 year returns)

Sector	#Stocks	Top quartile (%)	Bottom quartile (%)	IQR (pp)	Median (%)	Total spread (pp)
Electricals	30	51	-37	88	17	191
Bank	41	35	-19	54	8	119
Chemicals	117	1	-32	33	-19	500
Capital goods	147	15	-28	44	-12	228
IT	93	-10	-39	30	-24	558
Healthcare	127	14	-23	37	-8	250
FMCG	82	7	-30	36	-16	680
Iron & steel	60	24	-25	49	-3	312
Finance	139	18	-24	42	-4	908
Automobile	135	29	-15	43	6	289

pp - percentage point

Source: NAFA Asset Managers internal analysis. Returns are 1 year FY end figures

table 2

Simultaneous 52W high and low exposure by sector

Sector	#Stocks	Near 52W High (%)	Near 52W Low (%)	What this tells you
Healthcare	127	14	46	Simultaneously best & worst
Power	26	15	58	Diverging within same theme
Oil and Gas	19	11	37	No consensus direction
Non-ferrous metals	13	23	8	Concentrated winners
Chemicals	117	1	68	Broad pain, hidden survivors

Near High/Low defined as within 10% of the respective 52 week extreme

produced a top quartile return of +33 per cent against a bottom quartile of –11 per cent, a spread of 43 percentage point. In Capital Goods, 35 large-cap names produced a 45-percentage point IQR with a negative median of –13 per cent. In IT, both quartiles were in the red, but the gap between losing 14 per cent and losing 39 per cent came down entirely to stock selection, not sector direction.

The most-researched stocks in Indian equities still render sector-level calls an insufficient investment framework. Analyst coverage does not compress dispersion. It just means more people are confidently wrong about the same call.

WHAT SHOULD REPLACE SECTOR CALLS?

None of this means sector context is irrelevant. Understanding that a company operates in specialty chemicals versus commodity chemicals matters enormously. Knowing that a bank runs a retail-heavy book versus a corporate-heavy book matters. Regulatory tailwinds, capex cycles, commodity exposure: All of this is real and important.

The problem is aggregation. Sector calls take all of this nu-

ance and compress it into a single arrow, throwing away most of the information in the process.

What works instead is starting from the individual business. What is this specific company’s return on capital? How durable is its competitive position? What is the management’s track record on capital allocation? These are questions that sector labels simply cannot answer.

The sector is context. The stock is the call.

Knowing the sector explains far less of a stock’s return than knowing the stock itself.

The median IQR of 33 percentage point across all sectors is the empirical proof. In a world where the typical sector produces a 33-percentage point spread between its top- and bottom-quartile performers, a sector-level call is not wrong the way a bad stock pick is wrong. It is wrong at the level of the question being asked.

Like Arjuna at Dronacharya’s test, the question was never about the tree. It was always about the eye. Not “which sector?” but “which company?”

Balaji Vaidyanath is the Head of NAFA Asset Managers and Abinash Swamenathan heads its research

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The volatility in the markets is confounding many investors. Just as people thought fundamentals were deteriorating and getting all gloomy at the end of the week prior to last, markets delivered an astounding rebound last week. While it might have been difficult to forecast the events of last week that triggered the rally, these are times amongst many where technical analysis can provide clarity amid uncertainty.

Technical analysis is the study of historical price movement and use the same to forecast the future. It works on three major principles. One, market/price action discounts everything. Two, prices move in a specific trend. Last but not the least, history repeats itself.

Each principle can be used in its own way at the time of analysing and making forecast. In this article, we are going to see how the third principle, “History Repeats Itself”, is playing out well in the current market context in a specific index.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN?

History repeats itself means that any movement in the past is likely to happen again in the future as well. That is assume that the share price of Company A has moved up twice from ₹100 to ₹200 in the last five years. When the share price comes down to ₹100 again for the third time, any technical analyst

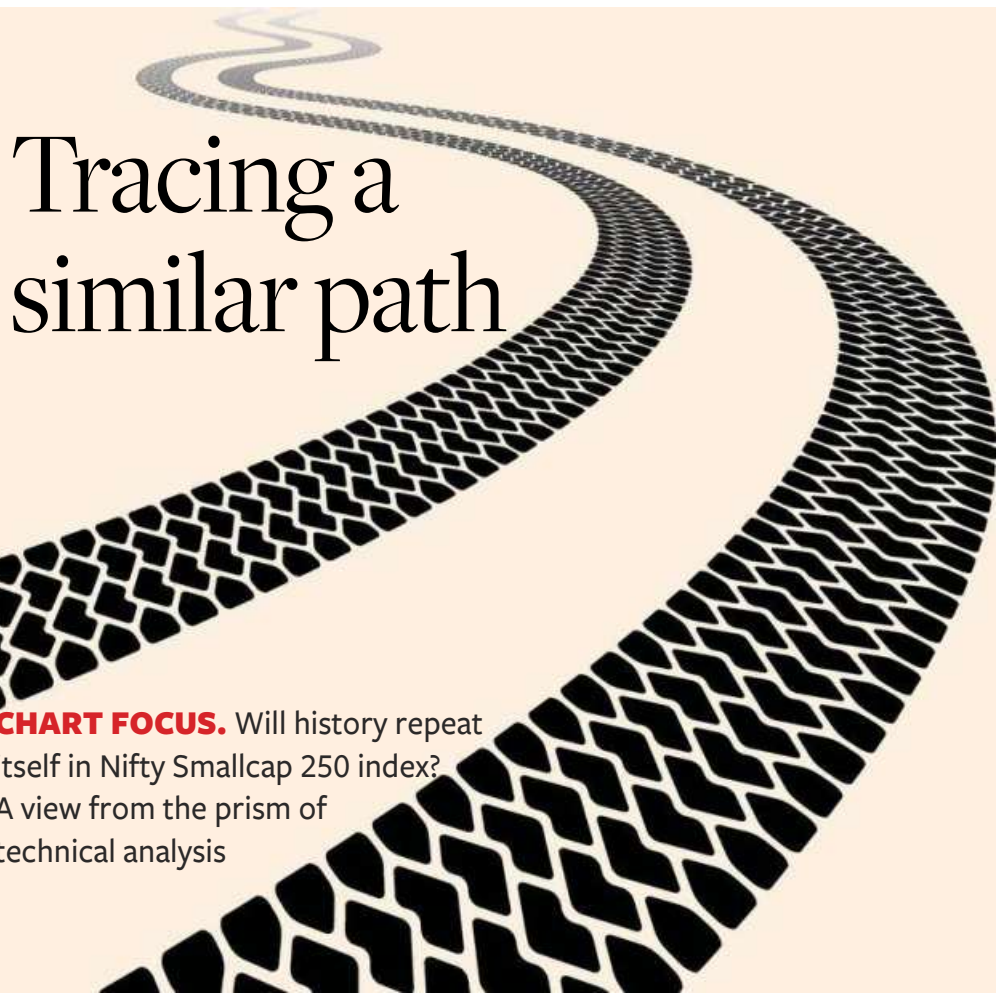


CHART FOCUS. Will history repeat itself in Nifty Smallcap 250 index? A view from the prism of technical analysis

would tend to buy that stock. This is by looking at historical movement, it will be assumed that the price will go back again to ₹200 from ₹100, for the third time as well. That is, the technical analyst would expect the

THE ADVANTAGE

Identifying a similar pattern can help to give an early entry or exit from the market

same pattern of movement to repeat again.

This principle not only applies to specific price levels, as mentioned in the above example. It will also help if a specific pattern or trend is spotted from the historical price movement.

HOW IT HELPS?

If you identify that a similar pattern of movement in the past is happening now, then it will help to give an early entry or exit

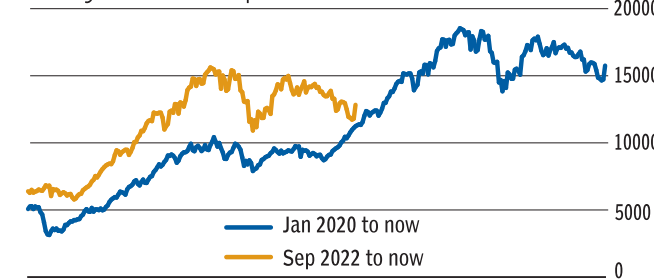
from the market. That is, you can be ahead in the market. This is one of the major advantages. However, the challenge lies in identifying that a movement happening in the market now is similar to that of what had happened in the past. This can be achieved by looking at the maximum historical data/chart rather than looking at the short-term picture.

WHAT’S BREWING NOW?

Nifty Smallcap 250 index seems to be repeating the history now. The index movement from September 2022 to now is tracing the same path as was seen from March 2020 to March 2023 (please refer the chart).

So, if history has to repeat itself, then the Nifty Smallcap 250

Nifty Smallcap 250 index



Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

After a prolonged multi-year rally, the market has seen a meaningful correction over the past few months. Several quality stocks across sectors have corrected and fundamentally sound businesses have seen their valuations cool off. For investors looking to use the correction to build exposure gradually through SIPs, value investing can be an effective route. A value-oriented fund can take advantage of temporary pessimism, buy quality businesses at lower valuations and potentially deliver better risk-adjusted returns over a market cycle.

Among the funds in this space, HSBC Value Fund stands out. The fund, which has 5 stars in our *bl. portfolio* Star Track MF Ratings, has delivered strong long-term returns while remaining faithful to its value-investing mandate. It has consistently outperformed its benchmark and most peers, without taking excessive portfolio risks.

PERFORMANCE

Launched in January 2010, HSBC Value Fund has a track record of more than 15 years and is managed by Venugopal Manghat. What makes the scheme stand out is not merely its recent returns, but the con-



FUND CALL. A proven performer, HSBC Value Fund has offered disciplined exposure to attractively valued quality businesses

sistency of its outperformance across timeframes and market cycles.

On rolling returns, the fund has comfortably outperformed both the value-fund category average and the Nifty 500 TRI. Over one, three, five and 10 years, the fund has delivered annualised returns of 23.5 per cent, 19.7 per cent, 18.1 per cent and 19.1 per cent, respectively. Against the Nifty 500 TRI, this translates into outperformance of 7.3 percentage points over one year, 5.7 points over three years, 4.5 points over five years

and 5.5 points over 10 years. This indicates that the fund has not merely benefited from market beta.

The scheme has been equally impressive for SIP investors. A monthly SIP over 10 years has generated returns of 16.8 per cent, compared with 12.5 per cent from the Nifty 500 TRI and 13.9 per cent for the value-fund category average. Even over five years, the fund's SIP return of 15.2 per cent is far ahead of the benchmark's 8 per cent and category's 10.9 per cent.

This ability to deliver in both lumpsum and SIP formats is important in the current market. Investors entering after a correction rarely invest everything at once. A fund that has historically rewarded staggered investing deserves greater consideration.

Equally important, the fund has not achieved these returns by taking extreme risks. The portfolio has historically fallen less than the benchmark during weak markets, while participating strongly in rallies. In the difficult FY26 market, for instance, the fund still managed a positive return of 4 per cent and was the second-best performer among nearly two dozen peers, even as the Nifty 50 ended the year with a decline.

PORTFOLIO

Many value funds drift away from their mandate during strong bull markets and end up chasing momentum-led sectors. HSBC Value Fund has largely avoided that trap.

The fund has stayed true to its value approach by focussing on businesses that combine reasonable valuations, sound balance sheets and long-term growth potential. The portfolio is built through bottom-up stock selection rather than sector calls.

Large-caps dominate the portfolio, but the fund also maintains meaningful exposure



WHY BUY

- Consistent outperformance across cycles
- Strong SIP returns during corrections and recoveries
- Diversified portfolio and reasonable costs

to mid- and small-cap stocks. Typically, 45-55 per cent of the portfolio is invested in mid- and small-caps, giving the fund the ability to benefit when broader market opportunities emerge (upside capture ratio of 118 per cent). At the same time, the presence of large-caps helps keep overall portfolio risk in check (downside capture ratio of 97 per cent).

The fund is also well-diversified. It typically holds more than 70 stocks, with even the largest positions accounting for less than 4.5 per cent of the portfolio. This reduces dependence on any one stock or sector.

Banks remain the largest allocation, accounting for nearly 23 per cent of the portfolio. Finance, IT software, petroleum products and industrial stocks also feature prominently. Some pockets of these sectors have either underperformed the market or seen valuation compression despite reasonable business fundamentals.

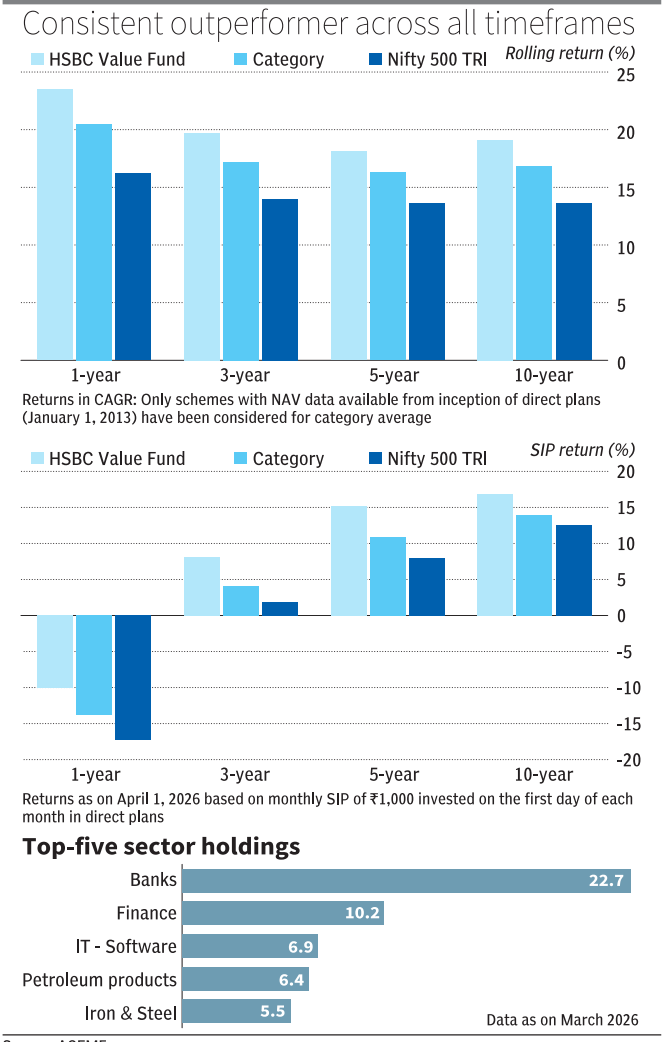
Among the fund's top holdings are SBI, NTPC, Karur Vysya Bank, Reliance Industries, HDFC Bank and Shriram Finance. Some of these are businesses with relatively inexpensive valuations compared to their own history or the broader market, but with the potential to benefit when sentiment improves.

SUITABLE THROUGH SIPs

The current environment is particularly favourable for SIP investing into a value fund. Market corrections tend to create a wider universe of attractively priced stocks. A staggered investment approach through SIPs allows investors to take advantage of this volatility without worrying about the exact market bottom. In that context, HSBC Value Fund's portfolio remains reasonably valued too, with a price-to-book of 4.1 times, placing it in the cheaper half of the value-fund category.

HSBC Value Fund is well-suited to such an approach. The fund usually remains fully invested and does not hold excessive cash unlike some peers. This ensures that its investors are able to participate when markets recover on a sustained basis. With a weighted average direct-plan expense ratio of 0.74 per cent (source: ACEMF), it is also among less expensive value funds, ranking in roughly the lowest one-third of the category by cost alone.

At the same time, the fund's diversified portfolio and lower downside capture make it relatively better placed than many aggressive mid- and small-cap funds if markets remain weak for some more time. Investors should, however, approach the scheme with a long-term horizon of at least five years. Value investing can go through phases of temporary underperformance. But over longer periods, patient investors are often rewarded as undervalued stocks revert to fair value.



3 real risks in systematic withdrawal plan

STRATEGY-WISE. A poorly designed SWP can silently destroy capital and distort income expectations

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Systematic Withdrawal Plans (SWPs) are often positioned as the mirror image of SIPs, a disciplined way to extract income from a mutual fund portfolio. The concept of SWP is simple. Invest a corpus in a mutual fund scheme, set a fixed withdrawal, and let the rest compound. But that simplicity hides structural risks. SWP is not a product; it is a withdrawal strategy layered on top of market-linked instruments that are exposed to draw-down risk. For investors, especially those transitioning from accumulation to distribution, understanding these risks is critical. A poorly designed SWP can silently destroy capital and distort income expectations. Let's look at the three real risks while opting for an SWP.

SEQUENCE OF RETURNS

When you start an SWP, the timing of market returns matters a lot. If markets fall in the early years of your withdrawals, like it has done in the past few months, it can hurt your retirement significantly. This is called sequence of returns risk.

In an SWP, you withdraw a fixed amount regularly. If the market is down at the beginning, you end up withdrawing from a falling portfolio.

This reduces your corpus faster. As a result, even when markets recover later, there is less money left to grow, increasing the risk of running out of funds during retirement.

Consider two retirees, A and B, each starting with ₹1 crore. Both withdraw ₹4 lakh annually



through SWP, increasing it by 5 per cent each year for inflation. Assume both earn similar average returns, but yearly performance differs. A gets strong returns first (25 per cent, 10 per cent, 14 per cent), then losses (-15 per cent, -9 per cent). B faces early losses (-15 per cent, -9 per cent), then gains (14 per cent, 10 per cent, 25 per cent). Though total returns are identical, the sequence differs. After five years, A has ₹98 lakh, while B has ₹85 lakh, showing how timing impacts outcomes.

How to manage this risk? Use a bucket strategy based on time horizons. Divide your portfolio into short-, medium-, and long-term buckets so that withdrawals are not forced from falling markets.

Keep 2-3 years of expenses in a short-term bucket and run your SWP from here. This bucket should be invested in low-volatility options such as liquid funds and short-duration debt funds. Allocate the rest across a medium-term bucket (up to 10 years) and a long-term bucket (beyond 10 years). These

SAFER SET-UP

Keep two to three years of expenses in low-risk funds before drawing from volatile assets.

can include a mix of debt, hybrid, and equity-oriented funds, allowing growth while protecting near-term withdrawals.

RATE MISCALIBRATION

Many investors set SWP withdrawals by comparing them with fixed deposit (FD) income. For example, if a ₹50 lakh FD gives 7 per cent, they expect the same from equity. This is flawed. Equity returns are volatile and capital is not guaranteed.

In reality, a safer withdrawal rate from pure equity is around 5-6 per cent annually. Yet many investors set 8-10 per cent, unknowingly drawing down their principal from the start.

Before starting an SWP, calculate your withdrawal rate (annual withdrawal divided by total corpus). If it exceeds 6 per cent

for equity, the risk of running out of money rises sharply.

Financial experts often recommend a conservative withdrawal rate from the retirement corpus, adjusted annually for inflation, as a safer option for retirees.

According to a study by Rajan Raju, Director, Invespar Pte Ltd, and Ravi Saraogi, Co-founder, Samasthiti Advisors, the safe withdrawal rate for an Indian retiree aged 60, with a life expectancy of 90 and a retirement period of around 30 years, falls within the range of approximately 3-3.5 per cent. This rate applies to the first year after retirement, with adjustments in subsequent years to reflect inflation.

SWP withdrawals should be adjusted periodically to keep pace with inflation. Instead of a fixed amount, increase withdrawals annually, say by 5-7 per cent, based on inflation trends. This helps maintain purchasing power but requires careful planning, as higher withdrawals can accelerate corpus depletion if returns do not keep up.

Build in a margin of safety while fixing the withdrawal rate, so temporary market falls, higher inflation, or longer life expectancy do not force premature depletion of the retirement corpus.

WRONG FUND CHOICE

Many investors prefer equity funds because of their higher return potential. However, regular withdrawals from pure equity funds can be risky, especially over short and medium horizons.

An SWP investor has two conflicting needs. The portfolio

must grow over time to sustain the corpus while also providing a steady monthly cash flow regardless of market conditions.

Problems arise when investors pick the wrong fund category. Using small-, mid-cap, or sector funds for SWP withdrawals can lead to sharp fluctuations in value, increasing the risk of early losses.

A short-term bucket should be parked in low-risk options such as liquid funds, ultra short-duration funds, low-duration funds, money market funds, or arbitrage funds.

Investors who are willing to take limited equity exposure can consider hybrid options like conservative hybrid funds, balanced advantage funds, and multi-asset funds.

Investors with stable alternative income sources and a higher tolerance for volatility may consider opting for an SWP in large-cap, flexi-cap, or multi-cap equity funds. Investors can refer to *bl.portfolio* MF Star Track ratings (<https://tinyurl.com/blmfratingsapril2026>) and pick four- and five-star-rated funds within relevant categories.

Investors also end up relying on a single fund. In an SWP, relying on a single fund means you are depending on one strategy, one fund manager, one asset mix, and one category behaving well for years.

If that fund underperforms, turns volatile, sees style headwinds, or suffers a sharp draw-down at the wrong time, both your income stream and capital base come under pressure. Diversifying SWP withdrawals across suitable funds can reduce this concentration risk.

ALERTS.

Axis MF's Nifty India Defence Index Fund

Axis Nifty India Defence Index Fund is an open-ended index fund tracking Nifty India Defence TRI. The NFO closes on April 24. Entry load is not applicable. Exit load, if redeemed/switched out within 15 days from the date of allotment, is at 0.25 per cent and nil if redeemed/switched out after 15 days. The minimum subscription amount is ₹100 and in multiples of ₹1 thereof. The performance will be benchmarked against Nifty India Defence TRI; its fund managers are Nandik Malik and Rohit Gautam. The investment objective is to provide returns before expenses that correspond to the performance of Nifty India Defence TRI.

Kotak MF's Multi Asset Active FOF

Kotak Multi Asset Active FOF is an open-ended fund of fund investing in units of equity-oriented schemes, debt-oriented schemes and commodity-based schemes. The NFO closes on April 22. Entry load is nil; 8 per cent of the units allotted shall be redeemed without any exit load on or before completion of 6 months from the date of allotment. Over 8 per cent, if redeemed or switched out on or before completion of 6 months from the date of allotment of units, exit load will be 1 per cent. If redeemed or switched out after completion of 6 months it will be nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹1,000 and any amount thereafter.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on April 10			
ETF				
Motilal Nifty Realty ETF	76	76	13	4,178
Groww Nifty Realty ETF	8	9	13	1,226
Groww Nifty Cap mkt ETF	10	10	12	2,017
Kotak Nifty Bank ETF	58	59	11	3,950
Motilal Nifty 200 Mom 30 ETF	62	62	11	586
ICICI Nifty200 Mom 30 ETF	31	31	11	8,092
ICICI Nifty Fin Serv ETF	31	31	10	2,778
GOLD ETFs				
AXIS GOLD ETF	146	124	3	12,563
LIC MF GOLD ETF	134	134	3	1,089
ICICI Pru GOLD ETF	128	128	3	39,047

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on April 10, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Apr 10	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	53.4	14.6	12.9	14.4	75,761
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.6	15.8	13.6	14.1	27,525
Kotak Pension Fund	66.7	15.1	13.6	14.0	4,151
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.6	6.9	5.9	8.3	8,462
SBI Pension Fund	41.0	7.0	5.9	7.8	27,593
HDFC Pension Fund	28.1	6.5	5.6	7.7	50,186
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.1	8.1	6.9	8.3	32,602
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.3	7.9	6.7	8.1	12,907
SBI Pension Fund	45.5	7.9	6.7	8.0	14,642
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	46.1	14.6	12.8	14.4	1,836
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.4	15.6	13.5	14.1	773
Kotak Pension Fund	58.6	15.1	13.5	13.9	202

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on April 10, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	-5.0	16.2	18.5
ICICI Pru	Largecap	768	-1.3	17.7	16.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	-1.5	16.6	14.0
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-8.2	11.7	13.6
MULTI CAP					
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	108	11.2	29.8	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	106	2.0	28.4	23.6
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	971	8.5	24.2	22.6
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	8,689	6.0	21.0	22.0
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	5,833	-2.6	31.5	21.6
Negen Capital Services	Special Situ & Tech Strategy	1,133	-2.1	24.3	21.4
MID-CAP					
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	312	2.0	13.0	15.9
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-5.3	13.3	15.9
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	-4.1	13.6	15.5
Nippon Life India Asset Mgmt	Emerging India	NA	0.1	17.4	14.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,788	43.5	45.5	44.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	712	-14.0	17.7	33.6
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,046	-19.5	28.3	22.9
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	-4.4	25.6	21.0

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on March 31, 2026

Gradually gearing up for growth

PHARMACEUTICALS. Caplin Point’s current base will support industry-level growth and it can get stronger from FY28

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Caplin Point has entered a consolidation phase, stock-price wise and business-momentum wise. The stock has returned 80-90 per cent from our first accumulate call in July 2022 to April 2024 and again delivered similar returns from April 2024 to January 2025. We recommended investors hold the stock and not add new positions in January 2025 and the stock has declined 28 per cent in the period. The hold call was based on valuations, reaching 32 times one-year forward earnings at the time. But with valuations now receding to five-year average levels of 19 times one-year forward earnings, we now recommend investors accumulate the stock.

Caplin Point manufactures generic medicines primarily aimed at Latin American markets and also the US markets. In the last one year, the sales growth of 11 per cent year on year has failed to enthuse investors who expect high growth from the company, even as PAT growth stands at 20 per cent year on year. In the consolidation phase, the company is, conservatively, gearing up for the next phase of growth; Chile, Mexico markets in Latin America (Latam), oncology portfolio launches, and expansion of its US label portfolio. The company is likely to sustain modest growth metrics and position itself for strong growth phase to resume from FY28.

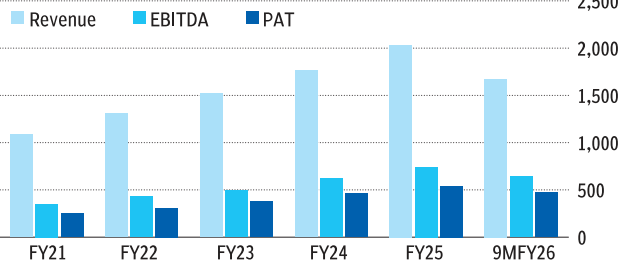
LATIN AMERICA

Latam accounted for 75 per cent of LTM (last 12 months) revenue, which includes Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua and a minor portion from Africa. The company’s business model involves last-mile presence in these markets, including its own warehouses and distributor network reaching out to pharmacists, doctors and stockists in these regions. On the supply side, it manufactures 60 per cent in-house and sources 40 per cent from outsourcing to China and India.

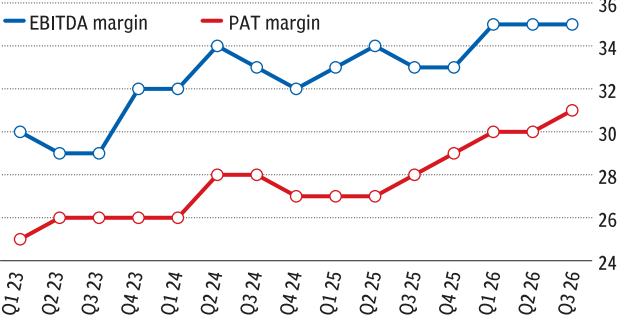
Growth has moderated in these regions with 8 per cent year-on-year growth in LTM as the smaller



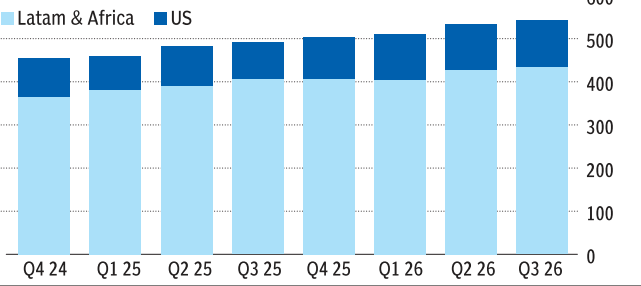
Financial performance



Strong margin growth



Increasing US contribution



markets face saturation. Mexico and Chile are the next larger markets for the company. But these markets have a long gestation period and are predominantly a government tender market which

prioritises local sourcing. The company now has its own warehouse in Chile and 125 product licences. The company is also eyeing a ₹150-crore capex to develop a manufacturing facility in Mexico

● ACCUMULATE

Caplin Point Labs
₹1,708.70

WHY

- Valuations have retraced to average
- Industry matching growth secured by base operations
- Next leg of growth in development

along with building a portfolio of 80 filings (35 have been filed). With a mix of private and tender market rollout for its pipeline of approved and in-process products from its facilities, the larger markets should drive significant growth from FY28, as per the company.

US MARKET

The company secured 27 US FDA approvals from FY24 to now. This has supported 21 per cent year-on-year growth LTM. The segment accounted for 25 per cent of revenue in LTM. All of the approvals are in the sterile space – solutions, injectables, emulsions and ophthalmic. This includes approval for complex suspension injectable recently (methylprednisolone – an anti-inflammatory). This allows lower price erosion and lower generic competition compared to oral solid dosage generics. The segment has reported a strong PBT margin of 12 per cent in LTM (and around 10 per cent PAT margin), even as the in-

vestment is underutilised (R&D cost, pending launches and its own front-end for sales). While the company relied on licensing in earlier periods, Caplin has developed its own sales front-end in the US and derives 75 per cent of the US revenues from the same, which has aided the margins.

The company currently has 55 ANDAs (generic application to US FDA) and has acquired four ANDAs with five more in prospects to supplement its pipeline. It should secure continued strong growth in the space owing to small base and strong pipeline in sterile space.

CAPITAL EXPANSION

Caplin is investing ₹1,000 crore, of which close to half has been deployed. The existing sterile facilities have been expanded, API (Active Pharma Ingredients) plant upgraded, and oncology formulation plant added. In FY27-28, the company is expected to commercialise three more facilities. An oncology API plant, an oral solid dosages plant and a new sterile facility across Chennai. These facilities will serve both Latam and US markets on commercialisation. Oncology API is to backward integrate with the formulation’s portfolio. The capex plan should enhance the existing (oral solids), the consolidating (US steriles) and the upcoming foray (oncology products).

Regulatory approvals for the new plants and product filing that will follow will ensure growth but only from FY28 for Caplin Point. The company should deliver industry-level revenue growth of 11-12 per cent year on year, primarily supported by US expansion in the next two years. It has a strong margin profile with gross and EBITDA margins of 60 per cent/35 per cent in the LTM, which have expanded and are expected to continue at the same level along with 11 per cent sales growth in the period. Caplin is well funded to execute capacity expansion with no debt and cash equivalents of ₹1,300 crore in December 2025. It may consider acquisition in US markets (ANDAs or formulations) with the cash reserves in addition to the capex.

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Apr 2	Apr 10		
Tata Motors PV	303.3	342.6	▲	13.0
Axis Bank	1,198.2	1,351.5	▲	12.8
Bajaj Finance	826.4	924.4	▲	11.9
Trent	3,553.5	3,918.7	▲	10.3
Bajaj Finserv	1,640.7	1,808.6	▲	10.2
Titan	4,097.8	4,502.2	▲	9.9
L&T	3,613.8	3,959.9	▲	9.6
Ultratech Cement	10,626.7	11,589.9	▲	9.1
Asian Paints	2,169.4	2,359.4	▲	8.8
ICICI Bank	1,216.1	1,322.0	▲	8.7
Maruti Suzuki	12,632.3	13,711.0	▲	8.5
M & M	3,011.7	3,261.8	▲	8.3
HDFC Bank	751.1	810.4	▲	7.9
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,377.3	1,475.1	▲	7.1
Tata Steel	194.1	206.6	▲	6.5
NTPC	360.0	380.3	▲	5.6
Bharat Electronics	421.5	442.3	▲	4.9
Kotak Mahindra Bank	358.2	374.8	▲	4.6
SBI	1,019.5	1,066.7	▲	4.6
Bharti Airtel	1,789.6	1,870.0	▲	4.5
Power Grid	289.9	302.6	▲	4.4
HUL	2,065.0	2,155.6	▲	4.4
ITC	292.9	304.2	▲	3.9
Eternal	231.7	240.3	▲	3.7
HCL Tech	1,401.9	1,450.9	▲	3.5
TCS	2,451.7	2,524.4	▲	3.0
Reliance Industries	1,350.9	1,350.2	▼	-0.1
Tech Mahindra	1,441.5	1,440.4	▼	-0.1
Infosys	1,300.5	1,292.4	▼	-0.6
Sun Pharma	1,694.7	1,654.7	▼	-2.4

How sectoral indices moved

	Apr 2	Apr 10	Movement	% change
REALTY	5,219	5,890	▲	12.9
AUTO	53,234	58,714	▲	10.3
CONSUMER DURABLES	53,320	58,203	▲	9.2
CAPITAL GOODS	66,360	72,181	▲	8.8
BANKEX	58,009	62,985	▲	8.6
POWER	6,753	7,287	▲	7.9
METALS	37,816	40,765	▲	7.8
PSU	20,130	21,286	▲	5.7
FMCG	17,087	17,831	▲	4.4
OIL&GAS	25,653	26,681	▲	4.0
HEALTHCARE	41,372	42,619	▲	3.0
TECK	15,194	15,606	▲	2.7
IT	29,288	29,902	▲	2.1

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	61,958	67,641	▲	9.2
BANK NIFTY	51,549	55,913	▲	8.5
NIFTY 500	20,938	22,347	▲	6.7
NIFTY 200	12,728	13,581	▲	6.7
NIFTY 100	23,304	24,810	▲	6.5

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I was founded a few days after India’s Independence by a freedom fighter and was named after a town that even now has fewer than 1,000 households.
- Like my previous chairman, my current chairman is highly qualified and has credentials from MIT. He named his two daughters after Sanskrit words meaning trust and dedication, values for which his family is widely respected.
- I own about 100 brands, and nearly half of my revenue comes from several countries, supported by subsidiaries across four major continents.
- I was one of the few 100-bagger stories of the last decade, but I have delivered disappointing returns in recent years.
- Despite the sharp rise in investor participation in the Indian small-cap segment, my shareholder base has remained broadly unchanged over the last five years.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to **who-am-i@thehindu.co.in**, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week’s stock: Allied Blenders & Distillers
Last week’s winner: Harsh Bola

Betting on a transformation

BANKING. With tech upgrades largely done, CSB Bank looks to become a full-service bank by FY30

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

We had given an ‘accumulate’ call on the stock of CSB Bank in February 2025 (after Q3 FY25 results), when the stock was trading at ₹306 or 1.2x its book value. The GNPA ratio then was 1.6 per cent. RoA (return on assets) for Q3 FY25 and 9M FY25 came in at 1.5 per cent and 1.4 per cent respectively.

Since our call, the stock made a 52-week high of ₹575 in early January 2026, reflecting strong growth in business— advances grew 30 per cent in FY25 and 29 per cent in H1 FY26. At this price, the P/B (price-to-book value) multiple works out to 2x. This, despite the bank’s GNPA ratio rising to 1.8 per cent. However, the stock started correcting soon, more steeply so towards the end of January, when gold price dropped sharply (gold loans account for half of the loan book). With Q3 earnings release coinciding, it only added to the selling pressure. The stock is now at a 30-per cent discount to its 52-week high.

The bank reported a 29 per cent and 21 per cent rise in advances and deposits in Q3 FY26. Net interest and fee income grew well, helping it post a 32 per cent growth in pre-provisioning operating profit (34 per cent in 9M FY26). However, the bad news came from asset quality. Provisions for NPAs rose to ₹77 crore from a mere ₹7 crore a year ago and ₹55 crore a quarter ago. Credit cost reached 0.7 per cent, which had been around 0.5 per cent in Q1 and Q2. GNPA ratio worsened to 2 per cent. Net profit growth was flat for the quarter and just about 7 per cent for 9M FY26. RoA for 9M FY26 slipped to 1.2 per cent. All these largely had to do with the bank’s SME portfolio, which accounts for about 12 per cent of gross advances. Yet, the bank is reasonably comfortable for the reasons included below.

Also, CSB is in the process of scaling up into a full-service bank by FY30 (discussed below)



Financial snapshot

	FY25	Q1 FY26	Q2 FY26	Q3 FY26	9M FY26
Loans (₹ crore)	31,842	32,944	34,712	37,161	37,161
Loan growth (%)	30	31	29	29	29
GNPA ratio (%)	1.6	1.8	1.8	2.0	2.0
NNPA ratio (%)	0.5	0.7	0.5	0.7	0.7
Credit cost (%)	0.3	0.5	0.5	0.7	0.6
RoA (%)	1.5	1.0	1.3	1.2	1.2

Source: Exchange filings

from being a gold-loan focused financier (current loan-book is just over ₹37,000 crore). Tech/system upgrades to support this are largely done, and the bank would enter the ‘scale’ phase from FY27. That said, FY27 would still be the first year in this phase and there may be initial hiccups in execution. Benefits are likely to accrue from FY28. CSB does have a fairly large footprint with about 850 branches to support the scale-up, comparable with Karur Vysya Bank’s 900 branches (loan book of ₹97,000 crore).

The two-week ceasefire helps one hope the energy crisis may not prolong to cause large-scale disruption to businesses, especially for SMEs. This coupled with the facts on SME book stated below put the bank in a reasonably-comfortable spot. However, this may not hold true if the crisis prolongs. This along with any execution hiccups in FY27 may cause some corrections in the share price, opening

● ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

CSB Bank ₹404.75

WHY

- Gold, corporate loans doing well
- Bank has healthy buffers
- Execution risk remains

up buying opportunities.

The stock currently trades at 1.5x its book value. The five-year average P/B ratio is 1.6x. With the worst of credit cost behind, the management expects RoA to return to 1.5 per cent by FY28. The transformed and scaled-up bank by FY30 should be more resilient with a larger but granular franchise, no longer heavily dependent on gold loans. Therefore, we suggest investors with a horizon of three years or more to accumulate the stock on dips of 10 per cent or more, as margin

of safety is more comfortable at those levels or lower.

SME TROUBLE

Gold loans, corporate loans, SME loans and retail loans share the ₹37,000-crore-odd loan-book in a 51:24:12:13 ratio. Gold and corporate portfolios are performing all right. But SME and retail aren’t and thus dominate the slippages. Some portions of the retail book such as two-wheeler, agri and microfinance loans experience stress and so the bank is consciously not growing them. Slippages from older accounts continue to show up though. Rest of the retail book appears to do well.

SME is the bigger problem. Slippages are primarily from those borrowers who were adversely affected by Trump’s tariffs. The management has cut back on disbursements—from an average growth of 47 per cent year-on-year in the quarters of FY25 to an average -7 per cent in 9M FY26.

However, the management is optimistic about the book as they have seen some accounts being upgraded as ‘performing’ in Q4 itself and the expectation is that about half of the slipped accounts would have been upgraded by March-end. Further, about 80 per cent of the SME book is collateralised.

Otherwise too, the bank has buffers from accelerated provisions and contingency provisions. Capital adequacy ratio is

healthy at 19.4 per cent.

GOLD LOAN LTV

Since late January, gold has corrected about 10 per cent. This is negative for CSB as it would mean higher LTV (loan-to-value) ratio of gold loans. If the ratio breaches the regulatory threshold (75-85 per cent based on the loan amount), it will lead to margin calls. It stands at 63 per cent as of Q3 FY26.

The management has stated that it does not take price risk with gold loans—meaning it does not take advantage of higher gold prices to lend more. Working with current gold price and accrued interest for Q4 FY26, the LTV works out to 57-59 per cent. Our estimates suggest that only if gold falls by at least 20 per cent from current level, will the LTV ratio reach 75 per cent.

VISION 2030

A key reason why the bank has not been able to expand into a full-service bank is the absence of systems to support diverse products. For instance, a new product like LAP (loan against property) would need its own suite of systems including the underwriting engine. CSB has invested in the same and they are largely in place now. By FY30, it envisages a loan-book mix of gold loans 25-30 per cent, corporate 30 per cent+, SME 18-20 per cent and retail the rest.

Once the products are in place, the bank can raise low-cost deposits unlike now, where 40 per cent of deposits are bulk deposits and low-cost CASA is just 21 per cent. In the above example, a LAP loan can typically spawn a current account. This could bring cost of funds down and aid higher RoA. However, with non-gold loans dominating the book, yield on advances would largely come to track benchmarks unlike now, where about 60 per cent of the book is based on fixed interest rates. Cost-to-income ratio falling to 50 per cent with scale (63 per cent for 9M FY26) can help offset this.

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,051) and Nifty Bank (55,913) snapped a six week decline by posting a notable gain of 5.9 per cent and 8.5 per cent respectively. For both indices, this is the biggest weekly gain since the first week of February 2021, an indication that the buyers could be coming back strongly.

FII's (Foreign Institutional Investors) have cut down net short on both index futures and index call options. While this may not be as much as a positive signal as a fresh long build-up would have been, it shows that the downside expectations are being moderated at the least.

Here's our analysis of futures and options data of both Nifty 50 and Nifty Bank index.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (April) (24,101) rallied to hit a one-month high of 24,120 on Friday before closing the session at 24,101. It has now closed comfortably above the 21-day moving average, adding to the brewing bullish sentiment.

As the contract ended 5.9 per cent higher last week, the outstanding Open Interest (OI) of April futures decreased from 214 lakh contracts to 193 lakh contracts. This denotes shorts exiting the system. With respect to options, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of April inched up from 0.95 to 1.03 over the past week. While the outright number might appear neutral, an increase in ratio shows that traders sold relatively greater number of put options during the period. Participants write puts when they hold positive bias.

The positioning in the derivatives segment for Nifty, as indicated by aforementioned numbers, hints that the ongoing rally can continue. Nifty futures can extend the upswing to 24,500, a potential hurdle. A breakout of this can lift it to 25,000. That



said, we cannot reject the possibility of a corrective decline, particularly after a sharp rally. If such a correction occurs, the contract can moderate to 23,600. A breach of this can drag it to 23,250.

Until 23,600 and 23,250 are safe, the bulls will have a case to build on last week's upward push. However, a breach of 23,250 might lead to the battle being lost to the bears. In such a scenario, a retest of 22,500 cannot be ruled out. Given the aforesaid considerations, it may not be ideal for traders to initiate longs at the current level. It would be wise to wait for a dip or a fresh breakout.

Strategy: If Nifty futures (April) breaks out of 24,200, go long with a stop-loss at 23,800. Book profits at 25,000. After buying, when the contract rises to 24,700, raise the stop-loss to 24,400.

Alternatively, instead of surpassing 24,200, if Nifty futures (April) starts to decline, initiate buy at 23,600 with a stop-loss at 23,200. When the contract rises to 24,200 and 24,700, tighten the stop-loss to 23,800 and 24,400 re-

- BROAD TREND**
- Six-week decline snapped decisively
 - Short covering drives sharp rebound
 - Upside likely, but entry timing key

spectively. Exit at 25,000.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (April) (56,106), too, marked a one-month high of 56,129.80 on Friday. It has overcome the barrier at 55,000 and the price is now above the 21-day moving average. While the contract rose 8.2 per cent over the last week, the outstanding OI fell from 24.7 lakh contracts to 21 lakh contracts, showing short covering. But the PCR of April options stood at 0.85, unchanged on a weekly basis.

The positioning in futures and options market for Nifty Bank futures might not be as bullish as for Nifty futures but its strong

relative outperformance shows good buying interests.

Going ahead, Nifty Bank futures could retest 54,125, its 21-day moving average. The downswing might even extend to 53,400. Nevertheless, we expect the contract to resume the rally by rebounding on either 54,125 or 53,400.

Once the uptrend resumes, Nifty Bank futures can see a run towards 59,000.

A breakout of this can take it to 60,000. However, if the support at 53,400 is invalidated, the contract might resume the down-trend and might slip again to 50,500. Support below this is 50,000.

Strategy: Buy if Nifty Bank futures (April) breaks out of 56,300 and keep a stop-loss at 55,000. When the contract touches 58,000, move the stop-loss to 56,900. Liquidate at 59,000.

In case Nifty Bank futures (April) drops to 54,125, go long with a stop-loss at 53,000. When the contract rises to 56,300 and 58,000, tighten the stop-loss to 55,000 and 56,900 respectively. Exit at 59,000.

Lag impact on OI effectiveness

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. It depends on when you use the OI measure to initiate a long position

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed why open interest (OI) is a more meaningful indicator of option liquidity compared to volumes. This week, we discuss whether a one-day lag in OI affects its usefulness as an indicator for liquidity.

LAG INDICATOR
OI captures cumulative open positions in a strike from the time it starts trading. So, the number is meaningful only at the end of trading each day. Suppose the OI in a strike is 25,000 till, say, Tuesday. Furthermore, suppose the total volume on the strike on Wednesday is 10,000 out of which 8,000 contracts were closed by the end of the trading day. So, the new OI as of Wednesday will be 27,000. That is, 25,000 carried forward open interest plus the 2,000 contracts added on Wednesday.

Now, if you were to use change in OI as an indicator for liquidity, you can only use the metric as of the previous day. So, to trade on Thursday, you will have to use the change in OI data (2,000 contracts per example) as of Wednesday. Is the one-day lag likely



- QUICK TIP**
- OI captures cumulative open positions in a strike from the time it starts trading

to distort the effectiveness of OI as an indicator of liquidity on the strike? The answer depends on when you use the OI measure to initiate a long position.

Take the weekly Nifty options which close on Tuesday. Typically, the change in OI builds up through the trading week till the penultimate day of expiry. This is

despite two important factors. One, weekend events including geo-political tensions across the world can lead to extreme volatility in the Nifty Index when it opens on Monday. And two, time decays on the options during weekends even though the markets are closed. That means change in OI can be effective as a liquidity measure Tuesday through Friday for the coming week expiry.

What about equity options? Equity options are delivery based, unlike index options, which are cash settled. Delivery margins are typically charged

starting four days from the expiry of the contract. While that would prompt some traders to close their positions, it should not impact the effectiveness of change in OI as a liquidity measure. This is because delivery margins are charged on in-the-money (ITM) contracts and the strike you will buy will be just out-of-the-money (OTM). That said, you must be mindful of OI as a liquidity measure, as traders tend to close their positions last Thursday through Tuesday of the expiry month.

OPTIONAL READING
If you believe significant number of contracts added to the OI yesterday will not be closed today, then OI should work as a good metric for liquidity. Volumes are good measure of liquidity for intraday trading in options. That said, the simplest way to ensure liquidity is to buy the immediate OTM strike on an underlying. Likewise, the simplest way to ensure that you will have good liquidity when you close your long position is to not let the strike become deep ITM.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Gold and silver futures face barrier

BULLION CUES. Traders with high risk-appetite can consider short positions

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Precious metals gained last week as sentiment in the market improved and the dollar fell. Gold (\$4,750/ounce) and silver (\$75.90/ounce) appreciated 1.6 per cent and 4 per cent respectively.

MCX gold futures (₹1,52,652/10 gm) rose 2 per cent whereas MCX silver futures (₹2,43,274/kg) was up 4.6 per cent. Here is our analysis:

GOLD (\$4,750)
The yellow metal posted gains for a second week in a row. However, the price action shows that it is struggling to surpass the barrier at \$4,800. A breakout of this and a subsequent rise past the 50-day moving average, now at \$4,900, can turn the near-term outlook bullish. A breakout of \$4,900 can take the contract to \$5,100. On the other hand, if there is a decline, gold can find support at



\$4,600. A breach of this can turn the outlook bearish again. In such a scenario, the price can decline to \$4,350.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,52,652)
Gold futures (June) extended the rally last week. Nevertheless, it has a resistance at ₹1,55,000 where the 50 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the prior downswing coincides. Only a clear breakout of ₹1,55,000 and a rally above ₹1,57,000 can give the contract a positive outlook. A rally past ₹1,57,000 can take the contract to ₹1,63,000 and

₹1,68,000. On the other hand, if gold futures declines, the support at ₹1,47,500 can arrest the fall. But if this is cracked, the contract can slip to ₹1,40,000.

Trade strategy: Stay out for now. Nevertheless, traders with higher risk appetite can short gold futures at ₹1,54,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,44,000 and ₹1,58,000 respectively.

SILVER (\$75.90)
Silver has gained for the third week in a row. However, the price action does not show such a strong uptrend as the weekly

gains project it to be. Resistances are at \$77 and \$79.25.

If the ongoing uptrend can take silver above the latter, the near-term view will turn positive. A breakout of \$79.25 can take it to \$88.

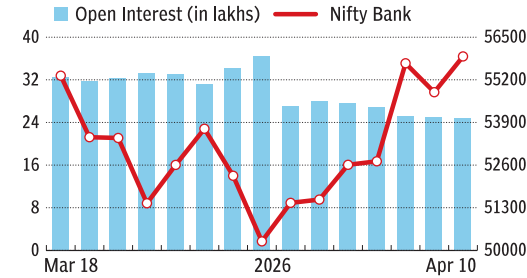
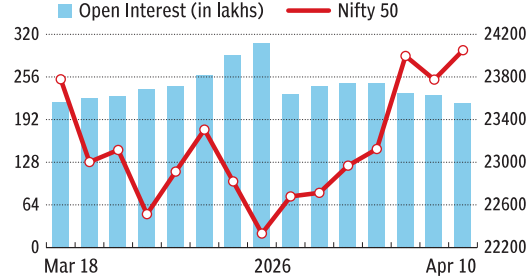
However, if the downtrend resumes from the current level, silver can fall to \$66, a support.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,43,274)
Silver futures (May) rallied last week. Although the price has been moving up over the last three weeks, the chart shows that this uptick could still be only a corrective rise. For this to become an uptrend, the contract should cross over the barrier at ₹2,54,000.

A rally past ₹2,54,000 can trigger an upswing to ₹2,80,000. Whereas if silver futures starts to fall from the current level, it can decline to ₹2,20,000

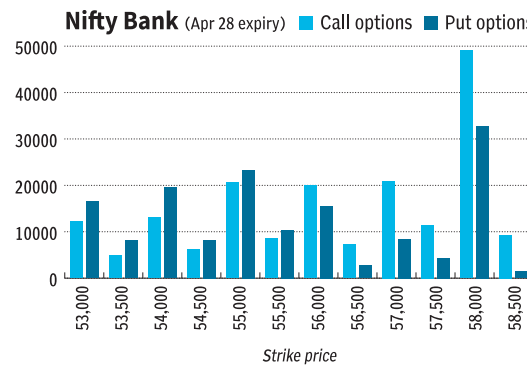
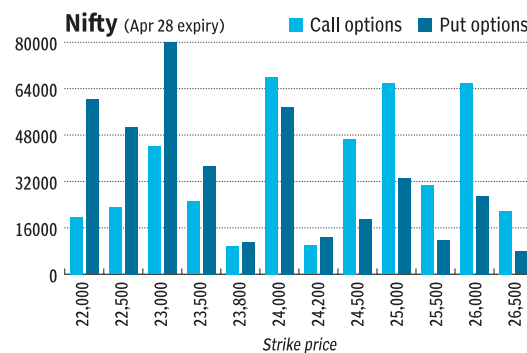
Trade strategy: Traders with higher risk appetite can short silver futures at ₹2,45,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,25,000 and ₹2,55,000 respectively.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

Put-Call ratio Nifty 1.03 | Nifty Bank 0.84



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Apr 10	Weekly change %	As on Apr 10	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	81432	20	219017	-18
Future Index Short	287659	-14	75813	-16
Net Futures	-206227	-23	143204	-19
Index Call options Long	517932	26	2484395	13
Index Call options Short	696530	5	2357634	17
Net Call options	-178598	-28	126761	-33
Index Put options Long	873651	11	2403652	25
Index Put options Short	540390	17	2862845	24
Net Put Options	333261	3	-459193	22

FII's have reduced net short on index futures. They've also cut down net short on index call options. These are indications that the FII's may be changing their views.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Apr 10)				
GODFRYPHLP	2,101.60	10.0	8.4	427.4
FORCEMOT	22,617.00	7.1	1.5	377.2
NAM-INDIA	955.25	15.1	30.3	284.3
ADANIPOWER	175.81	9.9	805.1	171.7
HYUNDAI	1,796.40	5.0	68.4	143.7
FALL (as on Apr 10)				
SAMMAANCAP	155.84	6.0	1410.9	-10.9
LTF	278.43	15.8	879.3	-3.7
HDFCBANK	810.30	7.9	4468.9	-3.5
OIL	471.30	-1.8	338.4	-3.1
TATATECH	566.25	4.6	107.4	-1.9

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Apr 13)

SAIL	SAMMAANCAP
------	------------

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Apr 10)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Apr	357.7 (0.9)	3,201 (6)	Long build-up
COPPER	30-Apr	1,210.2 (4.8)	9,137 (0)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	20-Apr	9,153.0 (-12.1)	7,686 (-51)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOILM	20-Apr	9,150.0 (-12.0)	29,358 (-43)	Long unwinding
GOLD	5-Jun	1,52,652.0 (2.0)	7,579 (14)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Apr	1,21,902.0 (2.2)	14,155 (-9)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-May	1,51,215.0 (2.1)	33,757 (12)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Apr	15,279.0 (2.3)	179,366 (-7)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	30-Apr	1,51,540.0 (2.0)	30,963 (1)	Long build-up
LEAD	30-Apr	193.6 (-0.8)	506 (60)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	27-Apr	248.7 (-5.8)	41,363 (13)	Short build-up
SILVER	5-May	2,43,274.0 (4.6)	5,742 (-1)	Short covering
SILVERM	30-Apr	2,45,100.0 (4.0)	14,459 (6)	Long build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	2,45,093.0 (4.0)	53,881 (8)	Long build-up
ZINC	30-Apr	331.0 (2.4)	1,985 (15)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Apr 10)				
USDINR	28-Apr	93.16 (-0.6)	19,41,982 (12)	Short build-up
EURINR	28-Apr	109.26 (0.2)	27,313 (7)	Long build-up
GBPINR	28-Apr	125.17 (0.4)	23,748 (-1)	Short covering
JPYINR	28-Apr	59.43 (0.3)	47 (38)	Long build-up

F&O Strategy

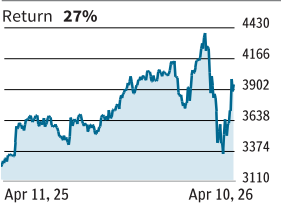
Buy L&T put

KS Badri Narayanan

Larsen & Toubro (₹3,959.90) remains in consolidation phase. Supports are ₹3,650 and ₹3,342. A conclusive close below the latter will turn the short-term outlook negative.

Resistance is at ₹4,280, which is the major one. A conclusive close above this will trigger a fresh rally. We expect L&T to move in a band with bearish bias.

F&O pointers: L&T April futures closed at ₹3,965.70 against the spot close of ₹3,959.90. Open interests has come down drastically from 1.43 crore shares on March 31 to 1.30 crore shares now even as the stock rallied.



The premium between future and spot price also narrowed down, signalling unwinding of long positions. Option trading signals that the stock could move in the ₹3,800-4,100 range.

Strategy: Consider buying 3,900-put on L&T that closed with a premium of ₹76.80. As the market lot is 175 shares, this would cost traders ₹13,440.

Keep initial stop-loss at ₹55. Shift it to ₹75 if L&T opens on a flattish note. Target can be ₹100-110. Traders should also bear it in a mind that the stock could swing wildly due to geopolitical concern. Stay away from this strategy if the L&T opens above ₹4,025 or below ₹3,900.

Follow-up: Dixon Technologies bounced back and hit our recommended target levels. Those who are still holding are advised to exit.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Finding S/R levels using strikes

bl. research bureau

Selling options require higher margins and the ability to take more risks as theoretically the loss is unlimited for a limited profit. In that sense, selling of options, not just call options but also put options are generally done by sophisticated participants like large institutions and high net worth individuals. Going by this logic, calls and puts with highest open interest (OI) are assumed to act as resistances and supports, respectively.



However, this is not a given and this logic can fail. Because as the market dynamics vary, these large institutions might change their view and may take fresh positions or modify existing trades accordingly. Also, we should remember that large investors and traders will generally implement multi-legged strategies. Meaning, rather than buying or selling plain vanilla call or put options, it can be combination of both and there is no limit to the ways in which strategies can be designed and executed.

So, as traders, one should always track how put-call ratio (PCR) changes over time rather than looking at it on one particular day. For instance, one should see how the PCR varies and in what direction the market has been moving over a two-week period. Suppose if PCR has been declining and the market is up, it is a bullish signal irrespective of who buys or sells options.

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, rose 5.8 per cent and 5.9 per cent, respectively, last week. BSE Realty and BSE Auto led the gains, delivering 12.9 per cent and 10.3 per cent, respectively, while BSE IT and BSE Teck lagged, rising 2.1 per cent and 2.7 per cent, respectively

	Nifty 50		Sensex		Auto		Bankex		Capital Goods		Consumer Durables		FMCG		Healthcare		IT		Metal		Oil & Gas		Power		PSU		Realty		Teck	
P/E	21.1		21.3		34.1		15.0		54.3		61.6		33.4		37.9		22.6		21.4		8.9		34.3		11.8		37.1		26.1	
P/BV	3.3		4.2		6.5		2.3		14.2		16.0		7.4		6.5		6.2		3.5		1.6		4.6		2.3		4.7		7.8	
Dividend Yield	1.3		1.2		1.2		1.1		0.4		0.5		1.5		0.6		2.7		1.4		2.8		1.1		2.3		0.4		2.1	
Weekly Return (%)	5.9 ▲		5.8 ▲		10.3 ▲		8.6 ▲		8.8 ▲		9.2 ▲		4.4 ▲		3.0 ▲		2.1 ▲		7.8 ▲		4.0 ▲		7.9 ▲		5.7 ▲		12.9 ▲		2.7 ▲	
Monthly Return (%)	-0.9 ▼		-0.8 ▼		-0.8 ▼		-1.6 ▼		3.0 ▲		1.6 ▲		-2.0 ▼		-2.9 ▼		2.7 ▲		4.1 ▲		-2.0 ▼		5.9 ▲		-0.7 ▼		1.8 ▲		1.8 ▲	
Annual Return (%)	7.4 ▲		5.0 ▲		30.1 ▲		9.6 ▲		25.9 ▲		8.7 ▲		-10.6 ▼		7.7 ▲		-6.6 ▼		53.2 ▲		10.9 ▲		14.8 ▲		21.7 ▲		-2.5 ▼		-2.0 ▼	

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 One [1]	1014.3	29.0	35.0	4.4	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	8.5	14.3	2.0	1273.0	812.3
3M India [1]	31530.6	542.7	58.1	16.6	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	5.9	39.8	0.0	38300.0	20282.1
A B B [2]	6866.0	78.8	87.2	18.6	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	11.7	9.8	0.1	6902.2	4640.5
Adani Estate [1]	1360.2	1.8	78.0	43.2	202512	59.8	388.2	123.3	-37.9	18.9	0.2	1.0	2535.0	108.8
Adarh Gas Fin. [1]	477.5	23.9	20.0	3.0	202512	18.2	22.7	18.7	20.0	6.6	11.4	2.8	5497.2	2642.0
Aarti Industries [5]	423.0	10.2	41.3	2.7	202512	25.8	22.1	13.3	1.6	3.5	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2
AAVAS Financiers [1]	1243.9	61.9	20.1	2.6	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	9.3	9.9	3.2	2238.4	1050.3
AAVASTECH India [1]	257.1	71.7	35.9	15.7	202512	30.7	14.9	25.9	10.2	12.8	15.9	0.0	6025.1	3300.6
ACC [1]	1424.5	134.0	10.6	1.3	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	7.3	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	268.7	8.3	32.4	3.4	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	31.9	-2.2	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7
Action Const.Eng. [2]	309.3	35.5	25.6	6.1	202512	-2.3	4.2	0.3	8.6	11.3	40.2	0.0	139.0	746.1
Adani Infra Sol. [1]	1158.0	18.7	61.9	6.0	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	7.1	14.0	0.9	1179.0	1148.3
Adani Enterp. [1]	2088.2	55.7	81.4	5.0	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	13.9	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1753.5
Adani Green [1]	1085.3	10.4	104.8	9.2	202512	7.6	-106.8	14.8	10.1	26.9	9.4	6.4	1179.2	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1475.1	54.8	26.9	4.0	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	7.1	14.0	0.9	1179.0	1148.3
Adani Power [2]	125.7	5.9	29.6	5.8	202512	-8.9	18.9	-1.9	12.2	9.9	21.2	0.7	182.8	101.1
Adani Total Gas [1]	580.7	5.8	99.5	14.2	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	11.7	17.4	0.4	797.4	453.5
Aditya AMC [1]	295.7	35.3	28.3	8.1	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	8.7	35.5	0.0	1044.4	594.5
Aditya Bir. Fas. [1]	60.4	-6.2	1.2	0.2	202512	7.9	-215.9	9.7	4.5	4.7	0.0	1.3	107.7	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	632.9	14.9	25.2	2.8	202512	27.4	20.8	13.6	36.9	4.7	14.4	0.4	369.3	53.8
Aegis Logistics [1]	632.9	21.9	28.9	3.2	202512	10.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	7.3	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0
Aether Industri. [1]	1190.8	16.9	70.6	6.8	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	7.7	9.7	0.1	1250.0	723.9
Afcons Engineering [2]	325.1	13.9	23.4	2.2	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	14.5	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.9
Affle 3i [2]	115.6	1.1	45.0	6.1	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	-2.0	16.0	0.1	2168.8	1251.9
Agni Infrastructure [2]	277.7	12.4	20.3	1.8	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	2.7	19.1	0.1	4200.0	300.0
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2803.5	81.2	34.5	8.1	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	0.3	32.0	0.1	2583.2	2335.0
Azko Nobel [2]	2978.2	83.0	35.9	6.0	202512	-13.6	-12.5	-7.0	-12.1	-0.2	39.1	0.1	3909.3	2649.1
21st Century Pharma [2]	724.0	33.8	21.4	2.7	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	10.4	13.1	0.2	1107.8	653.3
Alkem Lab [2]	5440.1	200.9	27.1	4.9	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	3.5	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8
Alkyl Amines [2]	1397.2	35.3	39.6	5.0	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	6.0	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	511.3	9.6	53.3	9.2	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	20.6	0.9	720.0	288.0	
Alok Industries [1]	13.9	1.5	-0.3	0.2	202512	-0.7	-179.7	-12.8	21.6	11.5	0.0	0.0	23.5	11.1
Alpena Raja Engr. [1]	742.3	3.1	19.8	7.2	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	4.7	10.7	10.7	0.0	1905.9	8.0
Amber Enterp. [1]	724.5	60.6	109.7	20.1	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	15.3	13.5	0.8	825.0	540.4
Amuba Cements [1]	45.1	15.7	28.4	2.0	202512	9.2	-89.9	16.4	-8.7	6.4	12.7	0.0	62.50	394.0
Anand Rathi Wels [1]	3584.7	47.7	75.2	29.8	202512	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	11.8	56.8	0.1	3678.7	1636.8
Anglo India [1]	488.4	14.6	33.4	3.2	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	8.1	10.9	1.4	741.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	280.8	8.4	33.2	4.4	202512	5.8	-4.6	-14.6	-22.5	6.7	32.8	0.8	208.9	208.9
Apna Indus. [1]	11349.5	246.9	46.0	9.4	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	15.4	32.6	0.1	11641.8	4819.2
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2064.2	41.1	50.2	12.4	202512	7.2	42.9	9.2	80.0	8.9	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1486.0
Apollo Hospitals [1]	292.7	31.9	30.7	3.2	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	2.7	17.5	0.6	809.9	689.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	438.4	23.0	19.1	1.8	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	7.2	10.9	0.3	540.3	392.3
Apurva Value Hou. [2]	223.2	17.8	12.6	2.4	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	11.9	15.1	0.5	364.9	193.5
Asahi India Glas [1]	869.3	12.3	70.7	6.0	202512	4.8	32.8	5.3	-4.7	6.2	13.1	0.9	1073.0	623.2
Asahi Sylvania [1]	288.4	10.0	28.8	2.9	202512	23.6	36.2	34.1	30.1	19.9	14.9	4.3	215.4	103.6
Asian Paints [1]	2359.4	42.6	55.4	11.6	202512	9.9	5.7	1.3	-4.6	8.8	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.0
Asster DM Health. [1]	681.2	7.0	97.1	8.4	202512	12.9	-10.1	8.3	38.5	3.4	11.6	0.5	723.0	486.6
Astral [1]	1630.6	19.2	85.0	11.6	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	4.8	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1240.5
Asterandhra Pharma [2]	88.5	1.9	46.2	9.6	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	4.7	10.7	10.7	0.0	1905.9	8.0
Ather Energy [1]	863.5	-16.9	12.1	0.2	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	-25.0	13.3	0.0	1.1	875.0	287.0
Atul [1]	6453.6	201.8	32.0	3.2	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	2.5	12.8	0.0	779.3	5252.0
AU Small Finance [1]	981.6	30.9	31.8	4.1	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	13.1	0.0	0.0	1038.8	551.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1350.0	68.0	22.2	2.2	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	1.1	14.2	0.2	1370.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	441.0	42.8	10.3	2.3	202512	-22.5	70.2	-16.0	-9.5	0.0	29.7	0.1	483.3	314.6
Avenue Super. [1]	4400.1	43.9	100.1	12.5	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	0.9	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	182.3	7.4	24.7	2.4	202512	10.5	30.0	21.8	19.5	-0.7	19.8	0.3	291.3	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1351.5	84.5	16.0	2.0	202512	4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	12.8	0.0	0.0	1413.3	1041.3

BHEL [2]	284.7	2.3	121.7	4.1	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	14.8	3.2	0.4	305.9	205.2
BPL CL [1]	299.4	57.6	5.2	1.4	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	7.6	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto	9813.7	319.9	30.7	8.0	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	12.0	28.1	0.2	1018.6	759.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	924.4	23.3	31.6	5.6	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	11.9	11.4	3.8	1012.5	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1806.6	62.1	29.1	11.1	202512	22.1	11.1	15.6	15.4	10.2	10.3	0.2	1018.6	759.1
Bajaj Holdings	9998.6	660.2	15.1	1.6	202512	127.6	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	11.2	11.5	0.1	104873.2	8597.9
Bajaj Housing	85.9	3.0	38.8	3.4	202512	18.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	10.2	9.5	4.7	13.0	17.0
Bakrishna Inds [2]	2712.2	67.9	33.5	4.2	202512	6.9	15.6	-26.0	10.0	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2046.0	
Balaram Chini [1]	125.9	1.2	45.0	0.1	202512	0.1	15.4	9.8	10.2	10.2	10.2	0.0	125.9	125.9
Bandhan Bank	168.1	6.3	26.9	1.1	202512	-0.9	-51.8	0.0	-59.4	14.9	0.0	0.0	192.5	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	276.0	37.6	7.3	0.9	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.7	10.5	0.0	0.0	325.6	211.2
Bank of India [2]	147.5	22.4	4.6	0.9	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	6.2	0.0	0.0	178.5	104.1
Bank of Maharashtra	8.0	0.5	2.4	0.1	202512	0.1	2.4	0.1	2.4	0.1	0.1	0.1	8.0	8.0
BASF India	3611.6	83.4	42.9	4.1	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	9.0	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2906.0
Bata India [5]	7153.4	149.9	47.9	6.0	202512	2.8	9.0	0.6	-23.4	8.8	14.6	0.3	300.1	605.0
Bayat Corp Sci.	1493.7	149.2	32.1	6.9	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	0.8	23.8	0.0	1540.0	676.9
BEML [2]	541.9	14.9	1.0	0.9	202512	0.9	23.9	8.4	-14.8	24.9	13.2	0.0	541.9	541.9
Berger Paints [1]	454.7	9.6	47.3	8.4	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	7.9	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1345.0	15.8	85.0	11.7	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	13.4	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0
Bharti Electron [1]	44.2	5.2	54.2	15.0	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	4.9	36.9	0.0	473.3	282.8
Bharti Net [2]	173.0	17.9	7.3	0.7	202512	0.7	19.1	8.4	1.5	19.5	18.2	0.0	173.0	173.0
Bharti Airtel [5]	1870.0	50.4	3.1	9.7	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.0	4.5	14.3	2.2	2714.2	1782.4
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1542.0	35.2	43.2	12.2	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	1.1	16.5	1.5	205.1	1438.6
Bikaji Foods [1]	324.0	10.0	64.3	10.7	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-3.8	11.8	15.4	0.2	820.9	591.0
Birla Cement [1]	69.0	1.1	69.0	1.5	202512	0.3	733.6	14.4	5.9	-2.1	11.1	0.0	425.9	308.0
Birla Corp [1]	944.4	74.2	12.7	1.2	202512	4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	5.9	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9
Birlsoft Ltd [2]	366.4	17.5	21.0	2.8	202512	-1.1	2.2	-2.6	-15.1	-11.2	20.8	0.0	473.8	320.0
BLU Electron [1]	288.5	15.6	18.4	5.6	202512	33.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	16.0	39.0	0.2	419.1	218.5
BLU Internet [2]	40.7	1.5	40.7	1.5	202512	0.1	40.7	1.5	40.7	1.5	40.7	1.5	40.7	40.7
BNS Health [1]	20.3	0.5	20.3	0.5	202512	-39.6	-39.4	20.6	25.1	1.6	40.0	0.0	1028.2	325.0
Blue Star [2]	1689.6	26.0	65.0	11.2	202512	4.2	7.0	9.5	-2.6	10.5	25.8	0.1	2104.0	1450.0
Bosch	3733.8	783.8	47.6	7.9	202512	9.4	-2.9	11.3	14.2	16.1	20.5	0.0	4149.8	2363.0
Canibees Soft [2]	24.9	-3.0	24.9	2.7	202512	11.6	77.2	12.4	0.0	8.7	0.4	0.0	24.9	24.9
Brigade Electron [1]	722.8	3.1	23.3	3.6	202512	1.6	-7.5	12.2	11.0	11.0	51.9	0.0	133.5	145.0
Britannia Inds [1]	5559.0	100.4	35.4	25.9	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	7.8	2.0	13.3	0.4	6337.0	5280.0

Where TMF yields are attractive

DEBT-WISE. Target Maturity Funds, with their predictable return profile, are well suited for goal-based investing

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

At its April 6-8, 2026 meeting, the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent and retained a neutral stance. Risks from the West Asia conflict, particularly via energy prices and supply chain disruptions, have strengthened the case for caution. While domestic fundamentals remain resilient, the Governor's remarks indicate that the MPC will closely track incoming data before moving on rates. However, with upside risks to inflation increasing and global uncertainty remaining high, the room for rate cuts appears limited for now.

With interest rates uncertain, debt allocations for a 1-4 year horizon look sensible. Target Maturity Funds (TMFs) offer a relatively predictable way to capture prevailing yields over short to medium term. In particular, TMFs maturing within 1-4 years look appealing, as their yields have risen notably over the past six months.

RETURN PREDICTABILITY TMFs are passively managed mutual funds, available as exchange traded funds (ETFs) or index funds, designed to replicate their benchmark indices by investing in underlying fixed-income securities in the same pro-



portion. What sets them apart is their greater return visibility than traditional open-ended debt funds. At the time of the New Fund Offer (NFO), asset management companies (AMCs) disclose the indicative YTM, which serves as a broad return indicator if the fund is held to maturity. Post-launch, YTM is updated on AMC websites—daily for ETFs and periodically for index funds. This predictable return profile makes TMFs well suited for goal-based investments. YTM is the annualised yield implied by a bond or portfolio if held to maturity, assuming scheduled payments are received.

Structurally, both index fund and ETF variants are open-

ended. TMF ETFs are traded on stock exchanges during market hours, while index funds can be bought or redeemed on business days at prevailing NAVs, like regular mutual funds. Index funds also offer both growth and dividend options. According to ACEMF data, there are currently 103 TMFs in the market, of which nine are ETFs and the rest index funds.

ATTRACTIVE SEGMENT Yields across TMFs have risen over the past six months due to a mix of global and domestic factors. Elevated crude oil prices amid geopolitical tensions have raised concerns over inflation and the current account deficit, pushing bond yields higher.

At the same time, heavy bond supply, especially during the financial year-end, and increased state borrowings have added to the upward pressure on yields. Foreign portfolio investor (FPI) outflows, amid rupee weakness and relatively better yields in developed markets, have further contributed to the rise. Interestingly, TMFs with residual maturities of 1-4 years have seen a sharper increase in YTM compared to longer-tenure segments of 7-11 years. Yields in the shorter segment rose by as much as 81 basis points, reflecting higher sensitivity to liquidity conditions, near-term rate expectations, and supply factors such as bank issuances and SDL (State development loans) supply.

As per ACEMF data as of April 11, 2026, there are 57 TMFs in the 1-4 year residual maturity segment. As of March 31, 2026, these funds offered YTM ranging between 6 and 7.8 per cent.

WHAT'S ON OFFER TMFs can be classified based on their underlying investments—government securities (gilt), SDLs, PSU bonds, NBFC bonds, or hybrid combinations such as gilt + SDL or PSU + SDL—each with a distinct risk-return profile. Gilt-heavy TMFs currently offer up to 6.6 per cent in the 1-4 year segment, with minimal credit risk.

Tata Nifty G-Sec Dec 2029 Index Fund offers the highest YTM of 6.64 per cent in this category. SDL-heavy TMFs offer slightly higher yields of up to 6.9 per cent. SDLs typically deliver 30-50 basis points more than gilts. Recent trends show SDLs becoming more attractive due to higher supply and improved liquidity, with mutual funds preferring issuances from fiscally stronger states. ICICI Pru Nifty

SDL Dec 2028 Index Fund offers the highest YTM of 6.9 per cent in this segment.

Among PSU bond-heavy TMFs, Bharat Bond ETF - April 2030 invests in AAA-rated public sector bonds and offers around 7.41 per cent, with a residual maturity of about four years. Compared to G-secs, it carries slightly higher credit risk, with the trade-off being a marginally higher yield along with a small increase in credit and liquidity risk. NBFC-based TMFs invest predominantly in AAA-rated bonds issued by financial sector entities, including NBFCs and housing finance companies. Unlike PSU or gilt-heavy TMFs, these funds are more concentrated in financial sector credit.

Interestingly, such passive funds can take 100 per cent exposure to a single sector, unlike active debt funds constrained by sectoral caps. They offer higher yields due to the spread over sovereign and PSU bonds, but with moderately higher credit and liquidity risk. Aditya Birla SL CRISIL-IBX AAA Financial Services Index - Sep 2027 Fund offers the highest YTM of 7.8 per cent in this category.

Among hybrid offerings, Nippon India Nifty SDL Plus G-Sec - Jun 2029 Maturity 70:30 Index Fund offers around 6.9 per cent, while Kotak Nifty SDL Plus AAA PSU Bond Jul 2028 60:40 Index Fund offers about 7.05 per cent.

TAKEAWAYS TMFs, with their predictable return profile, are well suited for goal-based investing. Investors can align these funds with specific time horizons, particularly for 1-4 year goals.

They also help reduce interest rate risk when held till maturity. For retail investors, index funds may be more convenient than ETFs due to ease of access. With a wide range of options, investors can choose based on risk appetite — gilt TMFs for safety, and financial-sector-focused TMFs for higher yields.

When selecting funds, investors should prefer those with lower expense ratios, minimal tracking error, and a larger corpus. Under the current tax framework, gains from TMFs are taxed as per the investor's income slab, similar to bank deposit interest. However, investors with lower taxable income, particularly those earning up to ₹12 lakh annually, including these gains, may effectively pay minimal or no tax, making TMFs a relatively more efficient option for stable income.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Mar 25
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Jan 31
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	6.1	6.6	6.25	6	Feb 11
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Apr 10
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Mar 11
DCB Bank	6.5	7.15	7.15	7.15	Mar 19
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Apr 10
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.4	7	7	Mar 19
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.65	6.15	6.15	Aug 01
Kotak Bank	6	6.7	6.7	6.4	Feb 11
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Apr 09
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05

SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	8	7.25	6	Mar 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	8	7.5	7.77	Mar 23
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

Data as on respective banks' website on 10 Apr 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

Tweaks in NPS health scheme

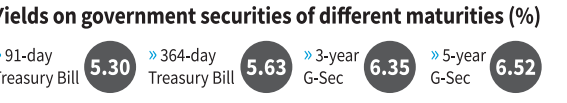
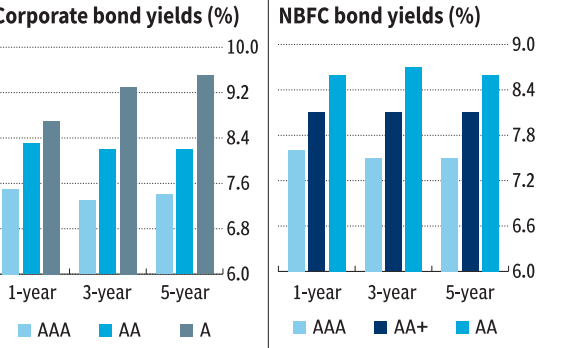
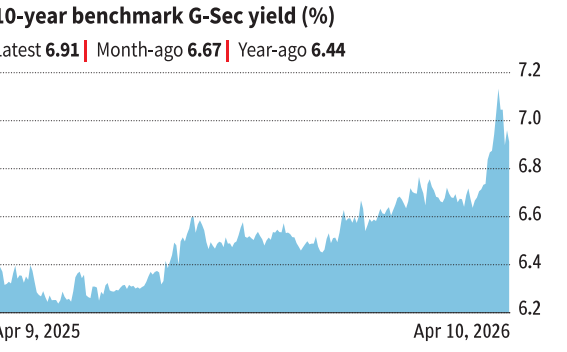
PFRA has allowed a modified proof of concept for the NPS Swasthya Pension. The health insurance benefit will now be mandatory, with premiums deducted through partial withdrawal from the subscriber's NPS Swasthya account. The minimum initial contribution for joining the scheme has been set at ₹25,000. A new provision permits full withdrawal subject to rules after large medical expenses.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5 ^a	7.5 ^a	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026. #Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

Bond yields



Source: Bloomberg (FIMMDA data), RBI Note: All data as on April 10, 2026 or latest available

INSURANCE QUERY.



SATISHWAR B

I am 40 years old. I live with my wife and son. My wife is a homemaker. I want to buy a term insurance for myself and my wife, but she does not have any salary slips. How can I buy the policy for her? Are there any special benefits for women?

Aman

It's excellent that you are proactive about securing life insurance for both yourself and your wife. This decision shows a commendable sense of responsibility towards your family's financial security. Ensuring that both of you have adequate coverage is an important aspect of comprehensive financial planning.

POLICY FOR YOUR WIFE

The good news is that homemakers are eligible for term insurance, even without

an income. Here's how you can secure coverage for your wife:

Income-based eligibility: As the earning member, your income serves as the basis for determining the sum assured for your wife.

Insurers typically allow homemakers to be insured for up to 50 per cent of the primary earner's coverage. For instance, if your policy's sum assured is ₹1 crore, your wife could be eligible for coverage up to ₹50 lakh.

Documents required: When applying, you'll need to provide your income proof, KYC documents, and any existing policy details.

Additionally, a medical examination might be required to assess health status. Digital tools make it possible to handle most of these requirements online, simplifying the process for you.

Policy options: Choosing separate policies for yourself and your wife will provide more flexibility in terms of managing coverage and adjusting it based on future financial changes.

Some insurers offer plans specifically designed with homemakers in mind, acknowledging their vital role in household stability.

SPECIAL BENEFITS

Life insurance for women, particularly homemakers, is crucial as it provides financial security in their absence, which could have significant emotional and economic impacts on a family. Recognising this, the insurance sector offers several benefits tailored specifically for women:

Lower premiums: Generally, premium rates are lower for women, which makes purchasing life insurance more cost-effective for families.

Critical illness riders: These are particularly beneficial for women as they cover diseases like breast and cervical cancer, which may be more prevalent. These riders can provide a lump sum payout, which can be used for treatment without impacting the family's financial stability.

Protected payouts: You can purchase your policy under the Married Women's Property Act (MWPA) and nominate your wife and/or children as beneficiaries. By doing this, you can ensure that, in your absence, the benefits are legally bound to go only to your wife and/or children. This legal protection prevents creditors from claiming these

benefits in case you have any financial liabilities.

ACTING NOW IS CRUCIAL

Securing life insurance early in life is not only cost-effective but also an essential part of planning for the future. The younger and healthier you are when you purchase life insurance, the better the rates and the more comprehensive the coverage.

Waiting to buy life insurance can result in higher premiums as you age, and health challenges may make it harder to secure coverage.

It is vitally important to secure life insurance for your wife as soon as possible.

The benefits of acting now include lower premiums and immediate coverage, which together provide peace of mind and substantial financial protection for the future.

By taking this step, you ensure that both you and your wife have the necessary safeguards in place, thus providing a stable financial foundation for your family.

The author is MD & CEO, Bandhan Life Insurance

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)		Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: April 11, 2026

Date: April 11, 2026, Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.1	15235	1.7	0.5	6.2	13.4	11.1	14.0	0.30
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	107.3	69948	1.4	0.9	8.9	16.1	14.8	14.8	0.45
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	88.1	46521	1.5	0.7	10.6	17.2	16.7	15.1	0.50
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1098.5	35458	1.6	1.0	6.9	13.5	13.8	13.8	0.39
*****	JM Large Cap	148.0	390	2.4	0.9	8.0	14.1	12.1	11.5	0.32
*****	Kotak Large Cap	555.4	9794	1.7	0.6	9.5	13.9	11.9	13.1	0.33
*****	SBI Large Cap	90.8	48926	1.5	0.8	10.4	13.1	11.7	12.6	0.33
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	505.3	26702	1.6	1.0	7.3	13.7	12.2	12.6	0.33
***	Bandhan Large Cap	75.1	1821	2.0	0.9	11.0	15.5	12.4	13.1	0.33
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	213.5	2344	2.0	0.8	8.1	14.4	12.4	13.0	0.34
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	81.6	1322	2.1	0.6	8.1	13.4	11.9	13.2	0.32
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	987.4	6821	1.9	1.1	8.5	13.1	10.5	11.3	0.28
***	Invesco India Largecap	67.6	1537	2.0	0.7	12.0	16.6	13.7	13.3	0.35
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.2	35343	1.5	0.6	8.3	11.6	10.4	13.5	0.27
***	Tata Large Cap	490.8	2448	2.0	1.0	8.7	13.7	12.3	12.3	0.33
***	UTI Large Cap	259.7	11203	1.8	0.9	5.3	11.3	9.7	12.0	0.24
**	DSP Large Cap	454.5	6620	1.8	0.9	5.2	16.2	12.1	12.2	0.36
**	HSBC Large Cap	467.2	1667	2.1	1.3	10.3	14.0	11.3	13.0	0.28
**	LIC MF Large Cap	52.4	1253	2.2	1.1	3.2	10.4	8.9	11.0	0.21
**	Union Largecap	22.7	403	2.6	1.8	7.7	11.7	10.5	-	0.26
**	Axis Large Cap	57.7	28661	1.6	0.7	4.5	11.1	8.1	12.4	0.17
*	Groww Largecap	42.2	117	2.5	1.3	11.9	13.4	11.0	11.7	0.27
**	PGIM India Large Cap	322.4	501	2.4	0.8	5.6	9.6	8.4	10.6	0.20
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.0	653	2.4	0.8	5.2	12.6	10.8	-	0.29
-	Taurus Large Cap	154.6	46	2.6	2.3	10.1	15.3	11.6	10.9	0.30
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	132.9	14109	1.7	0.5	13.6	22.6	18.2	16.4	0.53
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	326.8	25295	1.6	0.9	11.0	18.6	17.1	15.2	0.49
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	995.6	27005	1.6	0.8	11.2	20.0	19.0	16.2	0.62
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.0	13973	1.7	0.6	12.9	18.7	14.3	-	0.37
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	108.5	2782	2.0	0.8	4.2	15.7	14.8	15.5	0.39
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	622.9	34871	1.6	0.7	14.2	17.1	16.5	15.3	0.51
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	178.3	5234	1.8	0.9	13.3	21.0	17.3	14.8	0.53
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	88.0	422	2.3	1.1	15.6	16.7	14.4	13.2	0.40
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	239.2	22203	1.6	0.6	6.8	15.0	12.8	15.5	0.34
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	605.4	15780	1.7	0.6	9.6	19.3	15.1	15.5	0.44
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	85.9	4067	1.8	0.4	14.8	18.3	14.6	15.0	0.40
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	95.7	8436	1.8	0.6	14.3	23.3	16.8	16.2	0.42
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	339.4	27373	1.6	0.6	15.0	18.1	15.3	16.0	0.43
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	147.8	38138	1.5	0.6	14.7	16.3	13.2	17.4	0.35
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1429.8	6299	1.9	1.1	11.1	19.8	16.2	13.5	0.46
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	180.2	3135	2.0	1.3	9.2	15.4	12.6	11.8	0.34
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.0	2710	1.9	0.6	9.2	17.3	13.4	14.9	0.37
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	83.1	6031	1.8	0.7	10.4	16.0	13.5	14.6	0.35
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	470.4	7040	1.8	0.7	-0.3	10.3	10.9	12.7	0.28
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	887.8	5103	1.9	1.1	13.8	15.3	9.8	12.2	0.21
*	Navi Large & Midcap	34.2	267	2.3	0.5	9.3	12.4	11.7	13.1	0.30
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	26.8	4238	1.9	0.8	19.5	20.2	15.5	-	0.34
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1968.8	91335	1.3	0.7	10.5	20.1	19.7	17.1	0.63
*****	JM Flexicap	90.3	4504	1.8	0.7	3.2	18.0	16.1	16.6	0.44
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.6	128966	1.3	0.6	7.5	17.8	15.8	17.4	0.59
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.5	2957	1.9	0.4	12.5	17.6	14.7	15.2	0.39
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1560.8	17536	1.7	0.9	6.9	16.8	15.1	13.8	0.42
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	34.7	5332	1.8	0.5	8.6	12.0	10.4	14.1	0.27
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.1	2079	2.1	1.0	9.5	14.5	12.6	13.5	0.33
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1799.8	23018	1.7	0.9	14.4	17.8	13.5	14.6	0.37
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	201.8	6651	1.9	1.1	10.2	15.0	12.2	11.4	0.33
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	326.9	11922	1.7	0.6	10.1	14.1	12.0	14.5	0.33
***	DSP Flexi Cap	98.6	10726	1.7	0.7	7.8	16.0	12.1	14.6	0.30
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	211.7	4724	1.9	1.2	12.5	17.8	14.4	13.4	0.35
***	Kotak Flexicap	83.5	50146	1.5	0.6	13.5	16.0	12.8	14.3	0.34
***	SBI Flexicap	105.2	20626	1.7	0.8	7.5	12.1	10.7	12.5	0.28
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.2	3310	1.9	0.6	7.1	15.6	11.5	-	0.31
**	Axis Flexi Cap	25.6	11413	1.7	0.7	9.7	14.6	10.3	-	0.23
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	55.4	11679	1.7	0.8	3.9	20.6	11.6	12.9	0.27
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.0	232	2.2	0.6	14.8	13.3	11.8	-	0.31
**	UTI Flexi Cap	291.8	20438	1.7	1.1	0.9	9.3	6.1	11.9	0.10
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	94.3	895	2.3	1.6	12.1	13.5	10.2	10.5	0.25
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	118	2.4	0.5	5.1	9.8	8.7	-	0.18
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	214.3	306	2.7	2.6	6.6	13.5	10.7	10.2	0.28
-	Quant Flexi Cap	97.3	5687	1.9	0.7	10.9	17.4	17.9	19.1	0.48
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	274.3	2861	2.0	0.9	8.5	17.6	15.6	14.5	0.40
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	788.2	14681	1.8	1.0	11.3	19.7	16.8	15.3	0.49
-	Invesco India Multicap	119.2	3550	1.9	0.7	4.8	15.8	13.6	13.7	0.33
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	35.1	5661	1.8	0.5	15.2	20.1	17.2	-	0.45
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	287.9	46321	1.5	0.7	12.3	20.3	20.4	15.9	0.60
-	Quant Multi Cap	590.8	6574	1.8	0.7	5.6	12.0	13.0	16.9	0.32
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	361.7	2525	2.0	0.9	8.8	16.2	14.7	15.0	0.40
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	100.2	13554	1.7	0.5	17.1	25.0	20.0	18.6	0.54
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	194.8	85358	1.4	0.8	18.6	24.2	21.0	18.3	0.63
*****	Quant Mid Cap	202.3	7002	1.8	0.9	2.7	16.1	17.3	16.4	0.47
*****	Invesco India Midcap	173.4	9895	1.7	0.5	19.2	26.1	19.9	18.3	0.49
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	33.4	4099	1.9	0.5	15.9	23.9	19.3	-	0.52
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	90.5	31047	1.6	0.8	4.3	22.4	22.5	16.8	0.53
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4178.0	39676	1.5	0.7	17.9	25.5	21.2	19.2	0.58
***	Axis Midcap	111.4	28835	1.6	0.5	15.8	19.4	14.9	16.9	0.40
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	103.7	2129	2.0	0.5	17.6	21.1	16.7	15.9	0.46
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	316.8	6569	1.9	1.1	31.9	25.7	19.5	17.4	0.54
***	Kotak Midcap	133.3	55676	1.4	0.4	19.7	21.0	17.7	18.0	0.49
***	PGIM India Midcap	61.1	9681	1.7	0.5	9.4	13.4	13.4	15.8	0.37
***	SBI Midcap	224.5	20576	1.7	0.9	5.3	15.5	15.3	14.3	0.44
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1385.0	11898	1.7	0.9	17.1	24.4	18.8	15.5	0.51
***	Tata Mid Cap	432.2	4993	1.8	0.6	15.9	21.2	16.6	16.4	0.47
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	764.5	5493	1.9	1.0	13.6	20.1	16.2	14.0	0.43
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2601.9	10899	1.8	1.0	8.6	20.4	15.3	14.9	0.40
**	Taurus Mid Cap	112.2	109	2.5	1.9	7.7	15.0	12.2	14.9	0.31
**	UTI Mid Cap	289.1	10482	1.8	0.9	13.5	16.9	14.0	14.4	0.36
**	DSP Midcap	144.9	17492	1.7	0.7	18.2	20.1	13.1	15.2	0.34
**	HSBC Midcap	401.6	11342	1.7	0.7	26.3	25.1	17.6	17.0	0.42
**	LIC MF Midcap	27.7	301	2.5	1.4	12.1	19.8	13.8	-	0.33
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	160.8	61809	1.4	0.7	11.1	20.2	21.2	20.5	0.53
*****	Quant Small Cap	241.8	25821	1.7	0.8	9.6	19.6	21.7	18.2	0.52
*****	AXIS Small Cap	100.5	23919	1.6	0.6	10.1	17.1	17.1	17.9	0.49

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	45.2	1770	2.0	0.5	14.2	20.3	18.8	-	0.43
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	40.3	9208	1.7	0.4	15.4	23.5	20.4	-	0.50
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	194.2	15300	1.7	0.8	20.0	20.2	18.8	16.8	0.46
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	129.2	33724	1.6	0.7	11.8	16.8	18.5	17.6	0.48
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	81.2	7538	1.8	0.8	8.9	14.9	16.8	15.8	0.49
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	238.7	15157	1.7	0.6	6.1	14.3	14.2	16.5	0.36
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	253.1	2983	2.0	0.9	16.6	19.7	18.0	14.6	0.43
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	33.6	9621	1.7	0.4	-2.5	12.5	16.6	-	0.40
★★★★	Union Small Cap	49.3	1666	2.2	1.1	22.9	20.0	17.4	15.9	0.41
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	159.7	11724	1.8	0.9	8.6	17.8	18.4	15.2	0.44
★★	HSBC Small Cap	74.8	13882	1.7	0.7	9.4	16.0	18.9	18.1	0.43
★★	SBI Small Cap	160.4	32286	1.6	0.8	5.6	13.5	14.3	17.5	0.39
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	83.2	4449	1.9	0.9	15.5	18.2	13.4	13.0	0.31
★	LIC MF Small Cap	28.8	552	2.4	1.0	7.4	17.7	17.5	-	0.41
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	36.6	11603	1.7	0.6	10.5	15.1	18.1	-	0.47
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	41.7	5108	1.8	0.5	12.0	18.8	18.3	-	0.47
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
★★★★★	HSBC Value	110.4	13371	1.7	0.7	17.0	21.8	18.8	16.6	0.53
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	461.8	55852	1.5	1.0	10.1	18.4	18.5	15.7	0.69
★★★★	Bandhan Value	142.0	9042	1.8	0.7	7.7	15.6	16.0	15.9	0.48
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	217.7	7993	1.8	1.1	9.6	20.9	17.5	16.2	0.49
★★★★	HDFC Value	733.2	6588	1.8	1.0	13.9	18.5	15.9	14.4	0.44
★★★★	JM Value	88.9	721	2.3	1.2	4.1	17.6	15.9	16.4	0.40
★★★★	Templeton India Value	695.5	2005	2.0	0.9	9.0	15.9	17.0	14.8	0.50
★★★★	Union Value	27.9	337	2.5	1.2	14.0	17.7	15.2	-	0.43
★★★★	UTI Value	161.1	8663	1.9	1.2	8.9	17.1	14.1	12.2	0.41
★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	124.6	5639	1.9	1.0	14.8	19.3	15.1	12.8	0.38
★	Tata Value	342.6	7909	1.8	0.8	9.9	18.2	15.7	15.4	0.45
★	LIC MF Value	24.7	181	2.5	1.4	17.9	16.3	13.4	-	0.32
★	Quantum Value	117.1	1018	2.1	1.1	3.1	14.8	11.9	12.0	0.37
-	Groww Value	26.0	60	2.5	1.1	10.5	15.9	12.7	10.6	0.35
-	Sundaram Value	210.6	1212	2.3	1.7	7.2	11.9	11.5	11.8	0.32
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
★★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	135.4	15044	1.6	0.7	8.0	18.5	15.3	15.9	0.44
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	365.5	10978	1.7	0.8	15.2	16.9	16.8	19.8	0.44
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	422.7	28441	1.6	0.9	8.8	21.2	18.0	15.0	0.55
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	148.5	6274	1.8	0.7	10.0	14.3	13.9	15.3	0.40
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	158.2	1260	2.0	0.8	13.2	17.0	14.4	16.4	0.36
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	170.9	7810	1.7	0.6	10.8	14.3	12.4	14.9	0.34
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax Saver	1353.9	14615	1.7	1.1	7.5	18.8	18.1	14.6	0.58
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	45.9	196	2.4	1.0	8.0	17.4	14.3	15.8	0.37
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	47.6	22940	1.6	0.6	12.8	15.9	13.1	17.4	0.35
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	94.7	809	2.2	1.0	12.6	18.3	12.9	13.1	0.33
★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1393.4	5684	1.8	1.1	5.7	16.4	14.7	13.1	0.40
★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	908.4	12810	1.7	1.1	9.1	15.8	13.3	13.6	0.38
★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	270.8	5587	1.8	0.6	8.8	14.1	13.0	14.6	0.35
★★	Mahi Manu ELSS Tax Saver	27.0	828	2.2	0.8	6.7	12.4	12.3	-	0.33
★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	51.0	3969	1.8	0.7	20.5	23.9	18.0	17.1	0.39
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	116.3	193	2.1	0.9	3.2	14.7	11.9	12.0	0.37
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	489.2	1183	2.2	1.6	8.0	14.1	13.2	14.1	0.36
★★	Tata ELSS	44.2	4091	1.8	0.7	13.8	15.8	13.6	14.3	0.36
★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.2	772	2.4	1.4	10.8	14.2	13.1	13.1	0.35
★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	109.7	395	2.3	0.7	14.0	15.9	13.0	12.6	0.34
★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	130.5	3561	1.9	1.2	13.0	18.5	13.7	14.0	0.35
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	114.2	2293	1.9	0.8	4.1	14.5	10.9	13.2	0.25
★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	126.3	13422	1.7	1.0	11.6	17.2	14.7	11.6	0.30
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	32.2	638	2.3	0.8	3.3	9.6	11.2	12.9	0.40
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	195.3	3175	1.9	1.0	6.3	12.7	10.3	12.3	0.25
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	59.2	13117	1.7	1.0	13.5	15.0	9.0	11.1	0.20
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	91.7	29076	1.6	0.8	5.8	13.9	8.1	12.3	0.16
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	141.8	915	2.2	1.0	2.3	13.5	11.4	12.5	0.30
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.6	46	2.4	0.9	8.4	12.2	9.9	-	0.23
-	Navi ELSS Tax Saver	27.3	44	2.3	0.4	5.6	10.9	9.5	10.9	0.24
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.1	42	2.3	0.7	5.9	10.1	8.7	-	0.17
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	172.1	64	2.5	1.7	3.5	13.0	11.9	13.3	0.35
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	127.2	17664	1.6	0.5	7.2	18.0	14.8	15.7	0.40
-	Kotak Contra	147.1	4679	1.9	0.6	12.0	19.1	15.8	16.4	0.45
-	SBI Contra	369.4	43754	1.5	0.7	6.9	17.1	18.9	16.3	0.65
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	52.3	5912	1.8	0.6	10.5	20.8	20.7	16.6	0.70
★★★★	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	134.4	2141	2.1	1.2	5.8	14.7	15.6	15.5	0.59
★★★	LIC MF Dividend Yield	29.3	583	2.3	0.8	10.4	20.0	15.4	-	0.42
★★★	UTI Dividend Yield	174.1	3497	2.0	1.5	11.1	18.8	15.0	14.7	0.48
★★	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	145.7	1339	2.2	1.4	12.6	18.3	17.0	13.6	0.52
★	Sundaram Dividend Yield	132.4	810	2.3	1.1	7.3	15.0	12.7	15.2	0.41
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	179.4	2186	2.0	0.6	-2.1	13.1	14.8	13.3	0.41
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	29.3	1301	2.1	0.7	0.0	14.0	12.3	-	0.31
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumer Trends	101.2	1075	2.1	0.8	2.4	14.1	12.8	15.9	0.31
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	199.1	5478	1.8	0.8	2.2	13.3	12.3	14.5	0.31
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	86.5	4018	1.9	0.4	3.9	14.7	13.7	15.6	0.35
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	282.1	2644	2.0	0.9	-34.7	11.7	14.6	14.3	0.40
★★★★	Tata India Consumer	41.8	2261	2.0	0.8	4.6	16.9	13.7	16.0	0.35
★★	Sundaram Consumption	87.9	1294	2.2	1.2	-1.2	13.7	12.0	12.9	0.30
★★	UTI India Consumer	54.4	609	2.5	1.6	4.0	13.8	11.1	11.6	0.25
★	Mahi Manu Consumption	20.8	456	2.4	0.8	1.3	13.2	11.9	-	0.31
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	105.2	1439	2.1	0.8	12.3	17.8	15.1	15.6	0.35
★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	142.2	1480	2.1	0.8	19.1	21.3	16.6	16.5	0.37
★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Financial Serv	626.1	6721	1.8	1.0	11.8	17.3	16.9	15.1	0.40
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	61.2	3155	2.0	1.0	12.9	16.3	13.6	14.3	0.28
★★★★	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	128.4	9367	1.8	1.1	7.5	13.8	12.6	14.8	0.29
★★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	43.4	9380	1.8	0.7	16.5	20.2	14.5	17.1	0.33
★★★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	42.8	2743	1.9	0.5	11.0	16.3	13.4	15.7	0.30
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	47.6	346	2.4	0.8	10.8	16.5	12.2	13.4	0.24
★★	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	190.8	1213	2.2	1.1	11.9	16.1	13.5	12.8	0.29
★	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	21.0	239	2.5	1.2	14.3	11.9	11.5	10.4	0.24
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	52.9	10	2.5	1.9	9.3	12.6	11.7	13.8	0.24
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
★★★★★	SBI Technology Opport	187.6	4027	1.9	0.9	1.7	10.1	10.4	15.2	0.28
★★★★	ICICI Pru Technology	172.2	12575	1.8	1.0	0.1	8.8	8.3	15.5	0.21
★★	Franklin Ind Technology	146.7	1556	2.1	1.1	1.1	14.8	8.7	14.7	0.22
★★	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	145.8	3590	1.9	0.8	-0.2	7.0	7.2	15.3	0.17
★	Tata Digital India	39.9	9239	1.7	0.5	-2.0	7.9	7.6	14.6	0.18
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru P.H.D	37.9	6293	1.9	1.1	9.8	25.8	15.6	-	0.56
★★★★	DSP Healthcare	37.0	2892	1.9	0.7	4.2	20.1	12.8	-	0.43
★★★	Mirae Asset Healthcare	38.3	2754	1.9	0.5	11.9	23.1	14.0	-	0.48
★★	Nippon Ind Pharma	49.5	7988	1.8	0.9	7.7	21.6	13.3	14.2	0.47
★★	SBI Healthcare Opport	423.3	4064	1.9	0.9	7.6	24.7	15.6	12.0	0.57
★★	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	28.9	1229	2.1	0.7	5.3	21.4	13.2	11.8	0.46
★	UTI Healthcare	280.1	1056	2.3	1.3	10.2	24.2	13.7	12.5	0.46
-	LIC MF Healthcare	27.9	78	2.4	0.6	3.9	18.9	10.3	-	0.33
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
★★★★★	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	38.3	1282	2.0	0.7	15.9	19.0	16.4	-	0.45
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	397.6	46700	1.5	0.9	10.8	17.9	18.2	16.2	0.77
★★★★	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	425.1	1809	2.1	0.8	12.6	13.1	14.0	15.6	0.46
★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Aggressive Hybrid	27.3	1146	2.1	0.5	8.0	13.2	11.4	-	0.37
★★★★	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	62.6	3309	1.9	0.4	8.7	15.4	14.1	12.8	0.53
★★★★	JM Aggressive Hybrid	113.8	652	2.3	0.9	3.6	16.4	13.8	12.3	0.43
★★★★	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	61.8	7812	1.7	0.5	12.3	14.4	12.5	13.1	0.42
★★★★	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	399.3	6115	1.9	1.2	8.0	15.1	13.8	12.6	0.53
★★★	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	26.2	1676	2.1	0.6	14.1	15.5	12.7	-	0.41
★★★	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	354.9	10253	1.7	0.6	8.9	13.0	10.8	12.6	0.36
★★	DSP Aggressive Hybrid	343.9	10883	1.7	0.7	3.8	14.4	11.0	12.6	0.35
★★	Franklin Ind Aggressive Hybrid	262.0	2164	2.0	0.9	5.6	13.2	11.3	11.3	0.35

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %Ann	3 Month %Ann	6 Month %Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2104.0	1177	0.3	0.2	8.3	6.7	6.1	6.1	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	441.0	43022	0.4	0.2	8.6	6.9	6.3	6.3	-
- Axis Liquid	3047.8	30188	0.2	0.1	8.7	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3303.4	12083	0.2	0.1	8.5	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3152.8	1611	0.1	0.1	8.4	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3144.5	8599	0.3	0.1	8.3	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3294.3	4858	0.2	0.1	8.7	6.9	6.3	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3908.1	16866	0.2	0.1	8.6	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3500.0	8877	0.2	0.1	8.5	6.9	6.3	6.3	-
- Groww Liquid	2646.4	162	0.2	0.1	8.4	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5369.0	53982	0.3	0.2	8.7	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
- HSBC Liquid	2727.8	13434	0.2	0.1	8.6	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	404.9	42888	0.3	0.2	8.4	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3760.8	11723	0.2	0.2	8.6	6.8	6.3	6.3	-
- ITI Liquid	1423.4	58	0.3	0.1	8.0	6.4	6.0	6.1	-
- JM Liquid	74.6	2567	0.3	0.2	8.1	6.6	6.2	6.1	-
- Kotak Liquid	5529.0	33309	0.3	0.2	8.5	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4946.4	11106	0.2	0.1	8.7	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1780.9	1012	0.3	0.2	8.4	6.8	6.3	6.3	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2868.4	10562	0.2	0.1	8.4	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.4	1017	0.4	0.2	7.4	6.2	5.9	5.8	-
- Navi Liquid	29.6	62	0.2	0.2	6.8	5.9	5.7	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6677.1	25756	0.3	0.2	8.6	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1517.3	5171	0.2	0.1	8.5	6.9	6.3	6.1	-
- PGIM India Liquid	356.3	478	0.2	0.1	8.7	6.9	6.3	6.2	5.20
- Quant Liquid	43.1	1418	0.5	0.2	6.7	6.1	5.8	5.9	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.5	510	0.3	0.2	6.9	6.1	5.7	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4275.4	57891	0.3	0.2	8.6	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2411.2	5175	0.4	0.1	8.4	6.7	6.2	6.1	-
- Tata Liquid	4310.2	22316	0.3	0.2	8.5	6.8	6.3	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2632.9	5756	0.2	0.1	8.3	6.8	6.3	6.3	-
- UTI Liquid	4490.6	19763	0.3	0.2	8.7	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1470.6	592	0.3	0.2	8.5	6.8	6.2	6.1	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.8	25065	1.0	0.3	7.3	5.9	6.3	6.0	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9023	1.0	0.3	7.6	6.1	6.3	6.0	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	33.9	7790	1.1	0.4	6.9	5.7	6.0	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	45	0.9	0.4	5.7	5.4	5.9	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1276	1.1	0.3	6.7	5.4	5.9	5.7	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6376	1.0	0.4	7.3	6.0	6.1	5.8	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.3	14414	1.1	0.4	7.7	5.9	6.3	5.9	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.1	23777	0.9	0.4	7.2	6.1	6.3	6.0	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2526	0.9	0.3	7.9	6.4	6.4	6.0	-
- ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	35.9	31342	0.9	0.4	7.6	6.1	6.4	6.0	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.4	26370	1.1	0.4	7.3	5.9	6.4	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	73	0.9	0.2	7.5	6.7	6.6	6.2	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.0	353	1.1	0.4	6.0	5.4	5.9	5.6	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.2	67117	1.0	0.4	7.7	6.2	6.4	6.1	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.4	220	1.0	0.3	7.8	6.3	6.2	5.8	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	106	1.1	0.4	6.3	5.4	5.8	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3474	0.9	0.2	6.9	5.7	6.1	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.7	15788	1.0	0.3	7.1	5.8	6.2	5.9	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.1	100	1.0	0.4	7.1	5.9	6.0	5.5	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.4	41059	0.9	0.4	7.6	6.1	6.3	6.1	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	412	1.0	0.3	8.1	6.5	6.4	5.9	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.0	20686	1.1	0.3	7.8	6.0	6.3	6.0	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.7	241	1.0	0.4	7.4	5.8	6.0	5.7	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.7	10500	0.8	0.3	7.4	6.0	6.3	6.1	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	575.2	19348	0.6	0.3	6.6	7.3	7.3	6.3	8.68
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Dur	1617.0	705	0.5	0.3	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.2	-
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4219.0	9512	1.1	0.4	6.3	6.8	6.8	6.7	24.37
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	3528	0.5	0.3	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.9	13619	0.8	0.4	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.1	11.70
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1371.9	1640	0.5	0.1	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.2	1.22
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4429.9	3130	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.8	6.3	8.56
*** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	3958	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.6	10.59
*** DSP Ultra Short	3556.7	3560	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.6	8.42
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16037	0.7	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	4.28
*** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1419.6	2470	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.0	-
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2822.8	963	0.8	0.2	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.8	12.87
*** Kotak Savings	44.9	14989	0.8	0.4	6.2	6.7	6.8	5.9	7.59
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1440.5	194	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.87
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6263.0	11847	0.6	0.4	6.4	7.0	7.0	6.0	9.47
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1420.9	586	1.0	0.5	5.8	6.4	6.5	5.5	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3305.5	117	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.4	5.6	9.44
** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1379.9	187	1.2	0.2	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.5	2.88
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.5	161	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.3	6.5	5.6	-
** Tata Ultra Short Term	14.8	3955	1.2	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.6	5.6	8.31
* Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3968.0	483	1.0	0.4	5.9	6.5	6.5	5.4	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.1	411	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.6	5.7	4.8	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2792.1	1454	1.4	0.2	5.3	5.9	6.0	5.1	2.13

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	570.9	26665	0.6	0.4	6.7	7.4	7.6	6.5	6.87
***** UTI Low Duration	3719.4	2246	0.4	0.3	6.5	7.3	7.3	7.3	7.56
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3242.1	5455	0.7	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.2	6.2	9.83
***** DSP Low Duration	20.7	4669	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	60.3	22104	1.1	0.5	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	12.55
***** HSBC Low Duration	30.0	981	0.9	0.4	7.6	7.7	7.6	6.2	9.83
*** Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	684.8	10865	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.8	12.11
*** Bandhan Low Duration	40.3	5723	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
*** Canara Robeco Savings	44.1	1295	0.5	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.0	5.9	-
*** Invesco India Low Duration	3957.1	1659	0.7	0.3	6.3	7.0	7.0	5.9	6.15
*** JM Low Duration	38.7	212	0.9	0.4	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.8	5.86
*** Nippon Ind Low Duration	3912.9	8768	1.0	0.4	6.2	6.9	6.9	6.0	8.84
*** SBI Low Duration	3645.9	13583	1.0	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.8	3.90
*** Tata Treasury Advantage	4110.7	2460	0.6	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	3.03
** Kotak Low Duration	3490.0	15257	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.8	12.08
** Mahi Manu Low Duration	1706.6	555	1.1	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	5.6	13.73
** Mirae Asset Low Duration	2359.1	2333	0.9	0.2	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.7	3.86
** Sundaram Low Duration	3604.4	436	1.2	0.4	5.7	6.6	6.6	5.7	2.98
** Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.8	260	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.6	1.94
* LIC MF Low Duration	41.3	1830	1.2	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.7	5.6	2.85

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

***** Nippon Ind Money Market	4357.6	19420	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
***** UTI Money Market	3239.0	18344	0.2	0.1	6.6	7.3	7.4	6.4	-
***** Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	388.5	28780	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
***** Axis Money Market	1503.1	20349	0.3	0.2	6.6	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Money Market	398.5	31750	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.3	-
***** Kotak Money Market	4715.6	32331	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*** Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1446.7	4365	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.1	5.9	-
*** Franklin Ind Money Market	52.7	3959	0.3	0.1	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
*** HDFC Money Market	6002.0	28188	0.5	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*** PGIM India Money Market	1390.5	152	0.5	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
*** Sundaram Money Market	15.7	1943	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.1	-
*** Tata Money Market	4958.5	32382	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
** DSP Savings	55.2	8947	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
** HSBC Money Market	27.7	5970	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.1	5.9	-
** Invesco India Money Market	3193.3	7154	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	5.9	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

*** SBI Savings	43.4	34892	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
* Bandhan Money Market	42.3	13437	0.4	0.1	6.6	7.1	7.0	5.8	-
* Edelweiss Money Market	29.7	2508	0.7	0.1	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.5	-

DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Short Term	62.8	20688	1.1	0.5	6.1	7.4	7.4	6.4	10.50
***** UTI Short Duration	32.9	2359	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.9	7.0	7.0	9.41
***** Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.5	6501	1.0	0.4	5.6	7.2	7.1	6.2	14.38
***** Axis Short Duration	32.2	8342	0.9	0.4	6.1	7.4	7.3	6.1	7.99
***** HDFC Short Term Debt	33.3	14728	0.7	0.4	5.9	7.4	7.4	6.2	9.59
***** Nippon Ind Short Duration	54.9	6632	0.9	0.4	5.8	7.3	7.2	6.1	8.51
*** Bandhan Short Duration	59.5	8612	0.8	0.3	5.8	7.3	7.1	5.9	-
*** Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.3	280	1.1	0.4	5.3	6.9	6.9	5.7	1.80
*** HSBC Short Duration	27.5	3799	0.7	0.3	5.6	7.1	6.9	5.7	-
*** Kotak Bond Short Term	54.1	15582	1.1	0.4	5.2	6.9	6.8	5.7	-
*** Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	593	1.1	0.2	4.8	6.7	6.6	5.5	-
*** SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	14580	0.9	0.4	5.6	7.1	7.0	5.9	6.58
*** Sundaram Short Duration	46.0	190	0.7	0.3	5.5	7.1	7.0	6.0	2.62
*** Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.3	357	1.0	0.4	5.2	6.6	6.5	5.3	-
*** DSP Short Term	48.2	2903	0.9	0.4	5.1	6.8	6.7	5.6	-
*** Invesco India Short Duration	3694.4	712	1.1	0.4	5.3	6.8	6.8	5.5	3.91
*** Tata Short Term Bond	49.5	2785	1.2	0.3	4.7	6.5	6.5	5.4	-
*** Groww Short Term	2156.7	88	1.1	0.4	5.3	6.6	6.2	4.9	-
*** LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	188	1.2	0.4	5.1	6.6	6.5	5.2	5.69
- Bank of India Short Term Income	27.7	278	1.0	0.5	5.2	7.5	7.0	10.1	2.89
- Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.2	88	1.3	0.4	5.4	6.8	6.8	5.6	13.56

Draft Delhi EV Policy mandates shift to 3Ws by 2027, 2Ws by 2028; offers a slew of sops

GREEN PUSH. Frontloads incentives, gives scrappage benefits, pushes battery recycling, emission tracking and compliance

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The Delhi government on Saturday released a draft electric vehicle (EV) policy proposing that new registrations will be restricted to electric three-wheelers starting January 2027 and electric two-wheelers from April 2028, marking a shift from incentives-led adoption to a deadline-driven transition.

The draft Delhi EV Policy 2026–2030 sets clear electrification targets for key vehicle segments, supported by a combination of subsidies, scrappage incentives and tax exemptions aimed at accelerating early adoption.

WELL-CALIBRATED

Two- and three-wheelers are central to the policy, as they account for the majority of vehicles in Delhi and see high daily utilisation. Two-wheelers alone make up nearly 67 per cent of the city’s vehicle stock, making their



SUBSIDY CAP. Electric two-wheelers will be eligible for incentives of up to ₹10,000 per kWh, capped at ₹30,000 in the first year

electrification critical to the government’s emissions strategy.

Uday Narang, Founder and Chairman of electric three-wheeler maker Omega Seiki Mobility, said the policy strengthens the economic case for EV adoption. “The Delhi EV Policy 2026–2030 is a timely and well-calibrated intervention that reinforces the shift towards clean and sustainable mobility. By focusing on high-usage

segments like two- and three-wheelers and backing it with strong incentives, scrappage benefits and tax exemptions, the policy significantly strengthens the total cost of ownership advantage for electric vehicles,” he said.

To accelerate adoption ahead of the deadlines, the policy introduces a front-loaded incentive structure that tapers over three years. Electric two-wheelers will be eligible for in-

centives of up to ₹10,000 per kWh, capped at ₹30,000 in the first year, with support declining to ₹6,600 per kWh and ₹3,300 per kWh in subsequent years. Electric three-wheelers will receive ₹50,000 in the first year, reducing to ₹40,000 and ₹30,000 over the next two years, while N1 category electric goods vehicles will be eligible for incentives of up to ₹1 lakh initially.

SCRAPPAGE BENEFITS

The policy also links incentives to scrappage, offering benefits for replacing BS-IV and older vehicles within a defined timeframe, signalling a push towards faster fleet replacement.

In a key fiscal shift, the policy caps eligibility for road tax and registration fee exemptions for electric cars at an ex-showroom price of ₹30 lakh. Vehicles above this threshold will not receive any exemption, while strong hybrid vehicles below the cap will be eligible for a 50 per cent concession.

Industry executives welcomed the targeted approach. Hemant Kabra, Founder and Managing Director of electric two-wheeler maker BGauss Electric, said the policy aligns with existing EV economics. “The policy rightly focuses on segments where EV economics already make sense. The combination of early incentives and clear timelines will drive faster adoption, particularly in two-wheelers, where price sensitivity and running costs are critical.”

CHARGING INFRA

Beyond demand incentives, the draft policy introduces obligations for manufacturers and infrastructure providers. Original equipment manufacturers will be required to deploy charging infrastructure at dealerships, while Delhi Transco Limited will act as the nodal agency for planning and rolling out a city-wide charging and battery-swapping network, supported by a single-window clearance system.



Energy security: Misri wraps US visit, heads to Europe

Press Trust of India
New Delhi / Washington

Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri discussed furthering co-operation with the US in nuclear power and new energy areas such as coal gasification and LPG exports in his meeting with US Energy Secretary Chris Wright.

Wrapping up his three-day visit to the US, Misri’s discussion with Wright focussed on advancing energy security, deepening bilateral energy trade and identifying new avenues to strengthen the India-US Energy Partnership, the Indian Embassy in the US said. “Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri called on Energy Secretary Chris Wright @SecretaryWright @ENERGY. Discussions focused on advancing energy security, deepening bilateral energy trade, and identifying new avenues to strengthen the India-US Energy Partnership,” the Embassy said.

US Ambassador to India, Sergei Gor, who was also present at the meeting on Friday, said the US was ready to cooperate with India on civil nuclear development in addition to other areas such as coal gasification and US LPG exports.

Chief of the Air Staff A P Singh, who was also in the US, and visited the Peterson Space Force Base in Colorado Springs on Wednesday. “He interacted with General Gregory M Guillot (Commander US-NORTHCOM/NORAD) for a productive exchange of perspectives on complex operational modalities, reflecting the strength of the growing partnership,” the IAF said in a post on X.

EUROPE VISIT

From the US, Misri will undertake a three-day visit to Paris and Berlin beginning Sunday for high-level talks on energy,



Foreign Secretary
Vikram Misri

trade and defence — sectors that have become increasingly critical amid a fractured geopolitical landscape.

The West Asia crisis and its impact on energy security are expected to figure prominently in Misri’s talks with the interlocutors in Paris and Berlin.

In Paris, the Foreign Secretary will co-chair the India-France Foreign Office Consultations along with Martin Briens, Secretary General of the French Foreign Ministry, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said in a statement on Saturday.

In Berlin, Misri will co-chair the India-Germany Foreign Office Consultations alongside Géza Andreas von Geyr, State Secretary of the German Foreign Office, the MEA said.

The discussions would cover diverse domains of bilateral cooperation, including trade and investments, defence and security, technology, green energy, development cooperation, education and people-to-people ties, as well as global and regional matters of mutual interest, it said.

Misri is also expected to meet other dignitaries and senior government officials in Paris and Berlin.

It will provide an opportunity to review the full spectrum of India’s bilateral relations with both countries and advance ongoing cooperation across key priority areas, the MEA said.

Reliance seeks govt nod to buy Iranian oil

Bloomberg

Reliance Industries Ltd. has sought the Centre’s approval to import Iranian crude via four vessels, according to a person familiar with the matter, as the US sanctions waiver nears its April 19 expiry.

The operator of the world’s largest single-site refinery is looking to ensure any purchases remain compliant with US restrictions on Tehran and do not violate Indian laws, the person said, asking not to be identified due to the sensitivity of the discussions.

Indian refiners stepped up purchases of Russian oil after the Trump administration granted waivers that are set to expire this month.

That’s been reflected in the import figures, with about 1.9 million barrels a day of Moscow’s crude arriving in India last month, up from about 1.1 million in February, according to vessel tracking data compiled by Bloomberg.

LIMITED IMPORTS

Still, buying from Iran has seen limited traction, reflecting concerns over suppliers, intermediaries and payment mechanisms tied to sanctions. India hasn’t imported crude from Iran since 2019.

However, the Oil Ministry had said in a post on X earlier this month that India is buying oil and liquefied petroleum gas from Iran.



Supply constraints have deepened after disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz curtailed shipments to India, the world’s third-largest crude importer, forcing refiners including Reliance to seek alternative sources.

The company has previously turned to other producers that were sanctioned earlier. It has secured a US general licence to import Venezuelan crude.

Reliance, which accounted for nearly a third of India’s total imports of 1.7 million barrels a day from Russia last year, has seen those volumes plunge after the EU imposed restrictions on fuels made from Russian crude.

The Shipping Ministry has granted special clearance to four tankers — including the Comoros-flagged Kavit, Curacao-flagged Lenore, and Iran-flagged Felicity and Hedy — to facilitate potential cargoes, Reuters reported earlier Friday.

All four of the ships are sanctioned by the US, according to data compiled by Bloomberg.

A PERFECT MISSION



SAFE LANDING. The Artemis II capsule and its four-member crew safely splashed down in the Pacific Ocean after nearly 10 days in space, on Saturday. The crew comprised NASA astronauts Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover and Christina Koch, along with Canadian Space Agency astronaut Jeremy Hansen. With their flight now complete, the four astronauts have set NASA up for a moon landing by another crew in just two years and a full-blown moon base within the decade. AP

ED searches house of former Bengal minister Partha Chatterjee in teacher recruitment scam

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As the election fever heats up in West Bengal, the Enforcement Directorate on Saturday carried out searches at the residence of former State Education Minister and TMC leader Partha Chatterjee, who has been evading summons, in the teacher recruitment scam.

According to ED officials, Chatterjee, arrested in July 2022, did not respond to three summons issued to him for appearance in multiple cases filed against him in the recruitment of Primary Teachers, SSC

Assistant Teachers and SSC Group C and D staff. Money allegedly changed hands in the recruitment of around 26,000 teachers and other school staff by the West Bengal School Service Commission (SSC).

TERMED ILLEGAL

The recruitment done by the West Bengal SSC was declared illegal by the Calcutta High Court and the ruling was upheld by the Supreme Court, with judges describing the process “tainted” and based on “large scale fraud.”

The former State Education Minister, who had hit the headlines after the ED recovered over ₹21

crore in cash from the house of his associate, was suspended from the party after his arrest less than four years ago.

SUPREME COURT RULING

The TMC had also removed him from all party posts. The Supreme Court in May last year had asked the Mamata Banerjee government to give sanction to prosecute Partha Chatterjee since he was a State Minister at the time of the registration of the case against him and others.

After remaining in jail for three years and three months, he was granted bail in November 2025, by a lower court.

Govt stands with farmers during any crisis, says Agri Minister Chouhan at Unnat Krishi Mela

Prabhudatta Mishra
Raisen (M.P)

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Saturday inaugurated a three-day national level exhibition and conference — Unnat Krishi Mela — at Raisen, under Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan’s Vidisha Lok Sabha constituency in Madhya Pradesh. Union Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari is scheduled to join on Monday, the concluding day of the event.

Addressing the gathering of thousands of farmers from surrounding districts, Rajnath Singh said that the defence forces have been instructed to buy chemical-free fruits and vegetables directly from farmers in the vicinity of their bases so that growers do not have to travel long distance in search of buyers.

STRESSES RELEVANCE

When asked about the number of farmers to attend, Chouhan a day earlier tried to downplay it saying it is more relevant what farmers

take away from the conference. He appealed farmers to attend different sessions planned along with the exhibition as arrangements have been made to guide and help them with expert advice from scientists of the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR).

Shivraj, while defending the move to hold the conference at Raisen, said that farmers from hinterland are not able to reach Pusa Krishi Mela, a premier annual exhibition held in Delhi by ICAR’s Indian Agriculture Research Institute.

The Raisen event is happening at a time when the rabi season crop on 2.49 lakh hectares (as of April 8) has been damaged due to unseasonal rains and hailstorms, according to latest compiled estimates by States. This area may increase as and when States finalise the assessment of damage.

“The Modi government stands firmly with farmers in this crisis,” Chouhan said adding he has also consulted the Agriculture Minis-



Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Shivraj Singh Chouhan addresses a press conference at his residence in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh ANI

ters of the impacted States.

FERTILIZER SUPPLIES

On Friday, the Minister had said that the government is ensuring smooth nutrient supplies to shield farmers against global price swings caused by the West Asia war. Farmers are gearing up for the kharif sowing, slated to begin from June with the arrival of South-West monsoon.

Chouhan also said that the pilot scheme on distribution of fertilizers on the basis of land records has

shown good results and it will be scaled up for a nationwide roll out once the targeted 13-crore farmer IDs are created. So far, 9.29 crore farmer IDs have been generated where all information such as land holding, crops pattern, yield, and input usage are recorded.

He also said that State-specific agriculture roadmaps based on agro-climate zones are in the works, with five zonal kharif conferences planned this year, one at Jaipur already held last week.

Orbicular gets ‘tentative USFDA nod’ for generic Semaglutide

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Orbicular Pharmaceutical Technologies has received ‘tentative approval’ for a generic version of Ozempic (semaglutide injection), developed in partnership with Apotex.

The product will be marketed and commercialised in the US by Apotex Corp., the ANDA applicant.

“We are proud to have supported Apotex in this important programme. Their regulatory leadership, combined with Orbicular’s development and execution capabilities, has been central to securing the FDA Tentative Approval,” MS Mohan, Managing Director, Orbicular Pharmaceutical Technologies, said in a release on Saturday.

Barry Fishman, Chief Corporate Development Officer, Apotex, said: “Orbicular’s scientific depth and commitment to quality were instrumental in supporting this complex programme.”

Shriram Finance gets ratings upgrade after MUFG investment

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Following the recent strategic investment by MUFG Bank Ltd in Shriram Finance Ltd (SFL), credit rating agencies Crisil Ratings, ICRA and India Ratings & Research have upgraded the long-term credit rating for bank loan facilities, non-convertible debentures, subordinated debt, and fixed deposit programmes of SFL to “AAA with a stable outlook” from the earlier “AA+”.

The credit rating agencies also resolved the ratings from ‘Watch with Positive Implications’.

MUFG Bank recently acquired a 20 per cent equity stake via preferential issue of equity shares in SFL on a fully diluted basis at a total investment of ₹39,618 crore.

PIVOTAL TIE UP

Umesh Revankar, Executive Vice-Chairman, SFL, said: “The MUFG partnership has been a pivotal moment, and these rating up-



Rating agencies raise Shriram Finance’s long-term credit rating to ‘AAA’ from ‘AA+’

grades are a reflection of that. For us, it translates directly into lower borrowing costs and a stronger ability to serve our customers.”

Crisil Ratings, in a note, said the rating action considers the significantly strengthened capital profile of SFL with network crossing ₹1 lakh crore post the transaction (₹62,093 crore as on December 31, 2025) which will support the company’s growth plan over the medium term.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.